

**KINIING: PRESERVING THE CULTURAL FOOD OF
BENGUET IN THE FOOD INDUSTRY**

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ABSTRACT

This study explored the traditional practices, challenges, and sustainability strategies of *kiniing* production in Benguet. The researchers focused on how traditional knowledge, especially the use of smoking woods such as guava, alnus, and pine, affects the taste and aroma of *kiniing*. Through in-depth interviews with seven purposively selected *kiniing* producers from Atok one (1), Buguias two (2), Kabayan one (1), Kibungan one (1), and La Trinidad two (2). The study gathered narratives on the process, techniques, and cultural significance of *kiniing*. Findings revealed that seven (7) *kiniing* producers in Benguet have been making *kiniing* since they were young, two (2) and four (4) years. Some learned from their families, while others joined community programs. They make *kiniing* to earn money, preserve tradition, and serve both locals and tourists. Different woods like alnus, guava, *kallahan*, *pallayen* or oak tree, and pine give different smells and tastes to the meat. Most use closed metal drums for smoking, but one still uses open fire or *pugon*. Smoking takes from four (4) hours to three (3) days. They use both native and commercial pigs, native for flavor, commercial for lower cost. Their main problems include the high price of pigs, limited wood supply, poor packaging, and competition from cheaper products. Still, they continue the practice by teaching the youth, involving the community, and joining cultural events like the Adivay Festival, Strawberry Festivals, and trade fairs. Preserving *kiniing* helps protect culture and supports local food and income.

Key Words: *Kiniing, Benguet, Traditional Food, Smoked Pork, Cultural Preservation*

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CHAPTER I

INTRODUCTION

Background of the Study

Food preservation is an important practice worldwide. Many cultures use traditional ways like salting, smoking, drying, or fermenting meat to keep it from spoiling and to have food available for longer periods. These methods are passed down from generation to generation and shape local food traditions. In different parts of the world, salted and smoked pork products are common, such as dry-cured hams in Europe, or smoked sausages in the Americas (Sánchez-Macías et al., 2019). These preserved foods are often linked to cultural identity and are valued for their unique flavors. The practice of smoking meat is widespread, with diverse indigenous groups utilizing various woods and methods to impart distinctive flavors and extend shelf life without refrigeration (Sánchez-Macías et al., 2019). These traditional techniques not only preserve food but also carry cultural significance, helping communities maintain their culinary heritage in the face of changing times. Philippines has many indigenous food preservation methods used by various ethnic groups. One well-known Filipino traditional preservation is pork *etag* from Mountain Province, which is salted and smoked pork similar to *kiniing* in Benguet (Ngabit-Quitasol, 2014). These products show how indigenous people adapted to their environment by using natural resources and simple techniques to preserve meat without refrigerators.

Filipino traditional preserved meat is also often part of celebrations and rituals, highlighting its cultural importance. *Kiniing* is a unique food product mainly made in Benguet by the *Ibaloi* and *Kankanaey* people. It is a type of salted and smoked pork, preserved by curing with salt and drying it with smoke over several

days (Ngabit-Quitasol, 2014). The traditional way involves careful salting and smoking to avoid burning or over-smoking, which can spoil the taste. Locals use different types of wood, such as alnus and guava, which help give *kiniing* its special flavor (Ngabit-Quitasol, 2014). The practice started long ago when people had no refrigerators and needed to keep meat safe for long times, especially in mountain communities with colder weather. Today, municipalities like Buguias, and La Trinidad are known for producing *kiniing* (Ngabit-Quitasol, 2014).

Historically, *kiniing* has been produced since the early indigenous settlements in Benguet, with no exact recorded date, but certainly long before modern refrigeration. It originated as a practical way to preserve excess pork from communal feasts such as *cañao* (traditional rituals), where meat was salted and hung to dry over hearths in kitchens to be used for everyday cooking (Ngabit-Quitasol, 2014). The municipalities of Benguet known for *kiniing* production, include La Trinidad and Buguias, wherein La Trinidad is noted as a center for both production and local distribution of the product (Ngabit-Quitasol, 2014). However, among the various municipalities, Kabayan is considered one of the earliest communities to practice smoked pork preservation based on cultural documentation. According to a recent study, The *Ibaloy* communities of Kabayan in Benguet are recognized for preserving pork through traditional smoking methods long before the advent of refrigeration, primarily for subsistence and ritual purposes. They called this *kinuday*, which refers to a traditional smoked meat product of the *Ibaloy* people in Kabayan, Benguet, made by salting and preserving pork through slow smoking. It is prepared using native pigs and local wood sources, traditionally over an open hearth. Kinuday holds cultural and ritual value and was developed long before refrigeration as a method for food preservation during communal and subsistence

practices. (Garambas et al., 2022). This highlights Kabayan's early role in developing what is now widely recognized as *kiniing* in the Cordilleras.

The traditional methods of smoked meat production across various regions and countries offer a valuable foundation for understanding how different cultures preserve meat. For instance, in the province of Ifugao in the Philippines, a smoked meat called *etag* is prepared by salting and curing pork, then drying and smoking it over a wood fire primarily as part of traditional rituals and everyday use in upland communities (Ngabit-Quitasol, 2014). In Brazil, *carne de fumeiro* is an artisanal smoked pork product made in small rural smokehouses, where selected woods are used to impart specific aromas, and consumer trust is often tied to cultural knowledge and craftsmanship (Da Silva Lima et al., 2024). In Canada, Montreal-style smoked meat is prepared by drycuring beef brisket with spices, followed by hot smoking, creating a signature flavor and texture that has become a regional culinary icon (The Canadian Encyclopedia, 2021). Scandinavian countries utilize traditional cold-smoking techniques, particularly for fish, exposing meat to smoke at low temperatures to preserve it without cooking, enhancing shelf life and flavor (Britannica, 2025). In the U.S. state of Texas, slow smoking over hardwoods such as oak and hickory for long durations is central to barbecue culture, preserving and flavoring meat gently without burning (FSIS, 2023). These examples show how communities worldwide have refined smoking methods based on local resources and cultural needs. They provide a useful comparison for understanding the unique characteristics of Benguet's smoked meat traditions while reserving detailed discussion of the local *kiniing* method for later chapters.

Preserving *kiniing* is more than just saving a traditional food, it is about protecting the culture, history, and way of life of the people of Benguet. However,

there is still a lack of organized research on how producers can continue making *kiniing* while dealing with present-day challenges, such as changing consumer preferences and the rising cost of ingredients. This gap in knowledge needs to be addressed to ensure that the tradition of *kiniing* continues for future generations. As Dizon and Yap (2020) explained, many traditional food systems in the Philippines face growing challenges due to modernization, and there is a need for more research and support to help producers maintain cultural practices while adapting to changing markets. This study aims to explore how *kiniing* can be preserved and promoted in today's food industry while maintaining its traditional methods and cultural value.

This study will help many people who are involved in keeping the tradition of *kiniing* alive. It supports local producers in Benguet who use traditional ways to make *kiniing*, helping them improve the quality of their product while still keeping its original taste and process. The *Ibaloi*, *Kalanguya* and *Kankanaey* communities, who have passed down this practice for many years, will benefit as the study helps protect their cultural heritage. Farmers and small business owners who make and sell *kiniing* can use the findings to reach more customers while keeping the tradition strong. Researchers and scholars will also find this study useful in learning more about traditional food systems. Tourism officers and local government units can use the results to promote *kiniing* through events and programs. Consumers, both from Benguet and other places, will benefit from better awareness and more chances to enjoy traditional food. Lastly, policymakers and support agencies can use the study to create programs that help local producers, protect culture, and improve rural livelihoods. (Cardoso, Vidal, & Garcia, 2024).

Theoretical/Conceptual Framework

This study is based on the Cultural Sustainability Theory (Mason & Turner, 2020), which emphasizes the importance of preserving cultural traditions, practices, and knowledge systems amidst modern changes and development. It refers to the long-term maintenance of cultural beliefs, practices, heritage, and identity. The theory explains that culture is not static but always evolving, and therefore must be supported, protected, and adapted to survive in a globalized world. In Benguet, the traditional smoked pork known as *kiniing* represents more than just food, it carries the region's history, indigenous knowledge, and communal values. As modern food processing and globalization grow, traditional food practices are at risk of disappearing. Cultural Sustainability Theory supports the preservation and adaptation of these traditions to protect culinary heritage, reinforce community identity, and build economic resilience.

To deepen the analysis and understanding of *kiniing* within modern food systems, several sub-theories complement the Cultural Sustainability Theory.

Heritage Food Systems Theory emphasizes the value of traditional food practices that are linked to local culture, natural resources, and community knowledge. It explains how heritage foods like *kiniing* are connected to a region's ecological and cultural identity. By supporting local food systems, communities help preserve biodiversity, strengthen food security, and maintain traditional culinary skills (Capone, El Bilali, Debs, Cardone, & Driouech, 2022). *Kiniing*, which relies on locally sourced pork and specific types of smoking wood such as pine, guava, and alnus, exemplifies this link between natural resources and cultural practices.

Foodways Theory explores how food is not only a biological need but also a social and cultural expression. It investigates the traditions, rituals, and meanings people attach to the way food is produced, prepared, and consumed. The process of making *kiniing*, salting, curing, smoking in the *battang* (smokehouse), and sharing during festivals, demonstrates deeply embedded cultural traditions passed down through generations. This theory highlights the importance of preserving these practices as part of cultural identity (Joseph & Turner, 2020).

Research shows that traditional food products like *kiniing* are deeply affected by the types of resources used in their preparation. For instance, the kind of wood used for smoking are guava, alnus, or pine, not only affects taste and aroma but also the overall quality of the product (Garambas et al., 2022).

According to Rebouças et al. (2024), while traditional practices like those in Tublay preserve authenticity, they face growing pressure to comply with modern expectations, such as food safety and market appeal. Cardoso et al. (2024) further emphasize the importance of taste and aroma in traditional smoked meats, which are influenced by cultural preferences and preparation techniques.

The Food and Agriculture Organization (2021) highlights that traditional products, when adapted properly to market standards, can create new opportunities for rural livelihoods. This supports the idea that cultural preservation, when combined with innovation, can result in economic benefits. Dizon & Yap (2020) also found that there is a growing international demand for heritage food, suggesting that *kiniing* has potential for global success if producers can maintain authenticity while improving presentation and quality.

In summary, this research is grounded in the Cultural Sustainability Theory,

which serves as the primary lens for understanding how *kiniing* can be preserved and adapted in the modern food industry. It is supported by Heritage Food Systems Theory and Foodways Theory. Each of which helps explain different aspects of the preservation, transformation, and economic potential of *kiniing*. The literature reveals that while traditional food practices like *kiniing* are vulnerable to decline due to modernization, they also have the potential to evolve, thrive, and even become globally competitive, if efforts are made to preserve their cultural roots while embracing innovation. This theoretical framework will guide the research in exploring the delicate balance between preserving cultural identity and embracing modernity, especially within the context of Benguet's indigenous food culture.

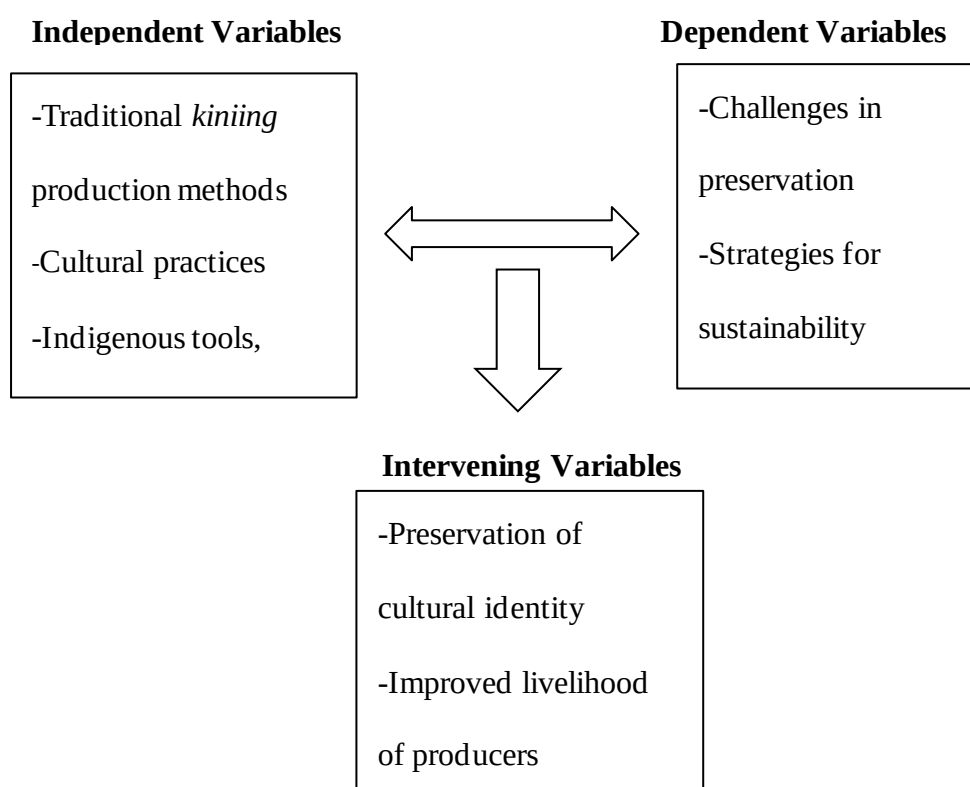


Figure 1 Paradigm of the Study

In this study, the independent variables include the traditional *kiniing* production methods, cultural practices, and indigenous tools, materials, and ingredients. These factors influence how *kiniing* is prepared and maintained, reflecting the customs and resources passed down through generations. These methods and traditions affect the dependent variables, which are the challenges in preserving *kiniing* and the strategies used to sustain it. Challenges may include rising costs of pig meat, limited supply of smoking wood, and declining interest from the younger generation. In response, producers adopt strategies such as involving the youth, improving smokehouses, promoting their products online, and participating in cultural events. The intervening variables connect these elements by showing how preserving traditional methods and addressing challenges lead to important outcomes, such as protecting cultural identity, improving the livelihood of producers, and promoting traditional food heritage to wider audiences.

Statement of the Problem

1. What are the traditional *kiniing* production methods of the selected municipalities of Benguet?
2. What are the challenges encountered by the producers in preserving *kiniing* as a traditional food while meeting consumer expectations?
3. What are strategies need to be implemented to sustain the preservation of *kiniing* in Benguet?

CHAPTER II

Methodology

Research Design

This study used a qualitative research method with a Grounded Theory approach to guide the research process in exploring and understanding the traditional practices, challenges, and implementation to sustain the preservation of *kiniing* in Benguet.

Qualitative research focused on understanding people's experiences, perspectives, and meanings behind their actions. According to Creswell and Poth (2024), qualitative research is best used when a deeper understanding of a topic is needed, especially when little is known about the issue or when the goal is to explore how individuals experience and describe a certain situation. In this study, qualitative methods helped explain how *kiniing* makers thought, felt, and decided when producing, preserving, and passing on their traditional pork-smoking methods.

The Grounded Theory design was chosen because it helps the researcher gather data based on the actual words and experiences of the participants. This approach allowed the researcher to collect data first through interviews, then look for patterns, themes, and ideas that came directly from the answers of the participants. As Connor, Flenady, Massey, and Dwyer (2024) explained, theories should come from the data itself, not from ideas that are already made before the study. By using the Grounded Theory approach, the researcher was able to create a deeper and more accurate understanding of *kiniing* production as seen through the eyes of local producers. This design fits the purpose of the study because it aims to

discover insights directly from the people who live the experience, not from books or pre-made theories.

Population and Locale of the Study

This study involved seven *kiniing* producers from selected municipalities in Benguet. Some of the municipalities that were included in this study were Atok one (1), Buguias two (2), Kabayan one (1), Kibungan one (1), and La Trinidad two (2), where *kiniing* production was still practiced. These areas were known for their agricultural heritage and strong community ties, which helped keep traditional food practices alive. The population included individuals who were actively engaged in the production of *kiniing*, whether for livelihood or business. These participants were chosen because of their experience and familiarity with the traditional *kiniing* smoking process.

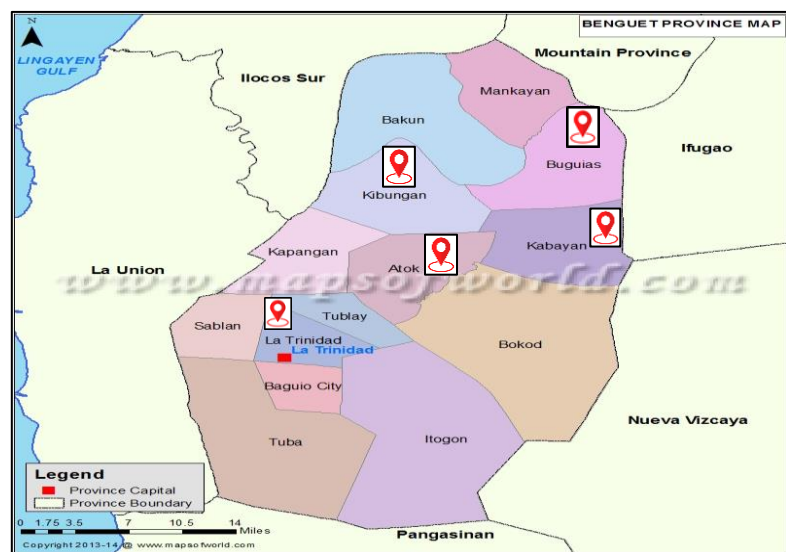
The selection of respondents was not done randomly. Instead, purposive sampling was used. This means that the researcher intentionally selected participants who are knowledgeable and experienced in making *kiniing*. According to Tajik, Golzar, and Noor (2024), purposive sampling is suitable for qualitative studies when the goal is to gain insights from individuals who have rich information related to the topic. This method ensures that the data collected is meaningful and directly relevant to answering the research questions.

The study was conducted in selected municipalities of Benguet Province, located in the Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR) in Northern Luzon, Philippines. Benguet is known for its mountainous terrain, cool climate, and rich cultural traditions. It is home to many indigenous groups, including the *Ibaloi*, *Kankanaey*, and *Kalanguya*, who have preserved various traditional practices,

including food preservation techniques like *kiniing*.

The choice of Benguet as the locale of the study is important, as *kiniing* is a deeply rooted cultural product of the province. Conducting the study in its place of origin ensures a better understanding of the practices, cultural significance, and sustainability efforts related to *kiniing*.

Map of Benguet



Source: <https://www.mapsofworld.com/philippines/provinces/benguet.html>

Data Gathering Tools

To effectively explore the traditional *kiniing* production, challenges they encountered and strategies related to the preservation of *kiniing* in Benguet, this study utilized a semi-structured interview guide as the primary data gathering tool. This tool was chosen because it allows flexibility during interviews while ensuring that key questions related to the research objectives are addressed. The use of interviews is appropriate for qualitative research, especially when using a Grounded Theory approach, as it allows the researcher to gather rich, in-depth information based on the lived experiences and perspectives of the participants.

In this study, interviews were conducted with selected *kiniing* producers from different municipalities in Benguet. The goal was to find out their personal experiences in traditional *kiniing* production, the challenges they encountered, and their strategies on how to preserve this cultural food practice.

Semi-structured interviews were found effective because they combined flexibility and focus. Researchers prepared a list of open-ended questions but could also follow up on interesting points making them ideal for discovering new ideas grounded in participants' lived experiences (Xu, 2024).

Data Gathering Procedures

Before collecting data, the researchers prepared a formal letter of request addressed to the Research Director's Office and the Research Ethics Committee. These letters explained the purpose of the study and asked for official approval to conduct the research. Once approved, the researchers also sent a letter to the National Commission on Indigenous Peoples (NCIP) Provincial Office of Benguet. The NCIP permitted to conduct the study but informed them that they did not have a complete list of *kiniing* producers across all municipalities of Benguet.

Because of this, the researchers used the approval letter from the NCIP Provincial Office to request permission from the five (5) selected municipalities where *kiniing* production is still practiced in Atok, Buguias, Kabayan, Kibungan, and La Trinidad. Some of these municipalities were able to provide lists of potential *kiniing* producers, while others did not have any formal records. From the available lists and referrals, the researchers selected seven respondents based on their knowledge, experience, and active engagement in the traditional process of making

kiniing. The researchers then communicated personally with the selected producers to explain the study and ask if they were willing to participate.

Once all approvals were secured and respondents agreed, the researchers began the actual data collection. Before each interview, the researchers explained the purpose of the study in a clear and respectful manner. They also asked for the informed consent of each respondent. Interviews were conducted face-to-face in the communities or homes of the participants, depending on what was most convenient for them.

The interviews were done in *Ilocano, Ibaloi, Kankanaey, Kalanguya* and Filipino, depending on the language preferred by the participant. Each interview lasted around twenty to forty minutes. With permission, the interviews were audio-recorded to make sure the information was accurate. The researchers used a semi-structured interview guide to ask questions related to *kiniing* production practices, challenges, and preservation strategies.

After the interviews, the researchers transcribed the recordings and translated them into English when needed. During transcription, the researchers included the participants' verbatim to preserve the authenticity of their responses. To check the accuracy of the results, some participants were asked to validate the findings through member checking. This step made sure that the interpretations of the researchers reflected the true experiences of the respondents.

The process of Grounded Theory in this study includes collecting data through interviews with *kiniing* producers. After gathering responses, the researcher read through the transcripts carefully and identified important ideas and repeated words or phrases. These ideas were then grouped into codes, which helped organize the data. Next, the researcher looked for connections between these codes

and formed categories or themes. As patterns became clear, the researcher continued comparing new data with the existing codes to improve the understanding. Finally, the researcher developed a general explanation or theory based on these themes, which came directly from what the participants shared (Connor et al., 2024).

Through this careful and respectful process, the study was able to gather important and meaningful insights about how *kiniing* is being preserved as a cultural food in Benguet.

Data Analysis

The data collected from the semi-structured interviews were transcribed and analyzed using thematic analysis. The researcher began with open coding by carefully reviewing the transcripts line by line to identify significant concepts and ideas. These codes were then grouped into related categories during axial coding to understand the relationships between them. Selective coding followed, where the core themes that best represented the study's main ideas were identified. Throughout the process, constant comparison was used to refine and validate the emerging themes, ensuring they accurately reflected the participants' experiences. To strengthen the credibility of the findings, member checking was conducted by sharing preliminary interpretations with some participants for their feedback. This thematic analysis allowed the study to develop a well-grounded understanding of the traditional practices, challenges, and strategies related to the preservation of *kiniing* in Benguet.

Ethical Consideration

This study followed ethical standards to protect the rights, dignity, and cultural values of the participants. Approval was secured from the Research Director's Office, the Research Ethics Committee, the National Commission on Indigenous Peoples (NCIP) Provincial Office of Benguet, and local municipal offices. Participation was voluntary, and informed consent was obtained after explaining the study's purpose and assuring participants they could withdraw at any time. Confidentiality was maintained by not recording personal information, and responses were used only for academic purposes. The researchers ensured cultural sensitivity and neutrality, avoided risks or bias, and respected the traditional knowledge shared by indigenous communities throughout the research process.

CHAPTER III

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

This chapter sets out the results and discussions based on the data gathered and analyzed. Particularly, it discusses the traditional *kiniing* production method used, challenges encountered by the producers, and strategies needed to be implemented to sustain the preservation of *kiniing* in Benguet.

It was presented and discussed in the first section that the traditional production methods of *kiniing* among selected municipalities in Benguet include long-established smoking techniques, specific preferences for wood types like alnus and guava, sourcing of pig meat, often native or commercially raise available, and a smoking duration that ensures both flavor and preservation. These practices help keep the traditional way of making *kiniing* alive while also making sure it stays safe and good for today's buyers.

Based on the data three (3) out of seven (7) respondents specifically, respondents one (1), two (2), and four (4) shared an experience of preparing *kiniing* for four (4) years. This consistent time frame suggests that a large portion of the respondents have already established familiarity and competence in the process. The fact that multiple respondents began this practice in recent years indicates that *kiniing* production has remained relevant and is actively being practiced over a sustained period. The data shows that most of the respondents have gained a strong foundation through several years of hands-on practice. This result is supported by Morton's Farm (2023), which explained that traditional smoked meat techniques are maintained over time by both long-standing and recent practitioners, proving

that the smoking process is practical, meaningful, and adaptable even to new contexts.

Three (3) out of seven (7) respondents shared experiences of producing *kiniing* since childhood or from a young age. Respondent three (3) mentioned, “*idibingak pay*”, expressing that the knowledge and practice of making *kiniing* started early in life, likely from observing and helping older family members. This kind of early exposure highlights that *kiniing* is not merely a modern livelihood activity, but a deeply rooted cultural tradition learned within the household and community. These early starters represent individuals who may have inherited both the skills and the cultural value of the practice, making them long-standing bearers of indigenous food traditions. This is strongly corroborated by the study of Garambas et al. (2022), who emphasized that the preparation of *kinuday*, a smoked pork delicacy closely related to *kiniing* is traditionally passed down through oral instruction and hands-on practice within families in Benguet. The findings confirm that food preservation practices in indigenous communities are often embedded in family life and taught from generation to generation.

Meanwhile, one (1) out of seven (7) respondents, shared experience of being involved in the preparation of *kiniing* for only two (2) years. Despite having fewer years of experience, this response highlights that the tradition is still accessible to newcomers, regardless of age or background. It suggests that cultural practices like *kiniing* are not limited to those born into it but can also be adopted intentionally. This aligns with the findings discussed in the blog article by ChadsBBQ (2023), which states that the tradition of meat smoking continues to evolve, being taken up by new generations and individuals who find value in learning and preserving the practice. This kind of active adaptation shows that indigenous food techniques are

being introduced to new hands, helping to ensure their continuity in a modern context.

The result highlights a range of experiences, from those who started during adulthood to those immersed in the practice since childhood. The presence of both seasoned and new producers demonstrates that *kiniing* is being preserved through dual pathways: long-standing cultural transmission and modern adaptation. This insight is further backed by the Slow Food Foundation (2023), which described *kiniing* as a heritage food that reflects the wisdom of indigenous communities, passed on but also increasingly recognized and revived as part of cultural identity and local economic development.

The data supports the Cultural Sustainability Theory, as it illustrates how culture, specifically traditional food practices, is sustained both through generational continuity and through adaptation over time. According to Soini and Birkeland (2014), cultural sustainability includes the transmission of heritage from one generation to the next, while also recognizing the role of innovation and adaptation in maintaining cultural relevance in a changing society. The respondents who learned *kiniing* as children reflect this generational continuity, while those who started later represent cultural adaptation in response to livelihood, interest, or community involvement. The continuation of the practice by both groups shows that *kiniing* remains a living tradition, actively shaped by the people practicing it today.

Furthermore, this interpretation is reinforced by the Foodways Theory by Counihan and Van Esterik (2013), which explains that food practices are embedded in social, historical, and cultural contexts. The data illustrates that whether learned at a young age or adopted in recent years, the making of *kiniing* is closely tied to

identity, community values, and practical needs. It reflects how food not only nourishes but also connects individuals to their heritage, enabling them to express cultural belonging and sustain local traditions.

Finally, the Heritage Food Systems Theory also applies here, as it stresses the role of traditional food practices in community resilience and cultural identity. The data demonstrates that *kiniing* is not a static tradition but one that continues to evolve while retaining its cultural roots fulfilling the criteria of heritage food as both a cultural expression and a sustainable livelihood opportunity.

Four (4) out of seven (7) respondents, said the production of *kiniing* serves both as a way to preserve cultural heritage and as a means of generating income. Respondent one (1) shared “*nagrugi idi ti Tabano–Omang a proyekto para iti pangkabuhayan*” the respondent explained that their involvement began through the Tabano–Omang livelihood project, which provided an opportunity to earn money while reviving traditional food practices. This program helped families produce and sell *kiniing*, supporting their daily needs while preserving cultural identity. Respondent five (5) stated that support from the Igorota Foundation allowed sponsorship and training, enabling income generation “*bayat ti panangsalaknib iti kultura mi*” the respondent said, while preserving their culture. Respondent six (6) mentioned that making *kiniing* began in 2013 after college, inspired by the interest of tourists in Igorot food. After learning the craft from a grandfather and father, vlogging began in 2018 to promote the traditional food and its cultural significance and started the business six (6) years ago. The use of modern platforms to preserve culture was further emphasized, as vlogging is now used to educate others, particularly tourists and youth, about the value of *kiniing*. This method serves as both cultural promotion and education. According to

ScienceDirect (2024), digital tools like vlogs are effective in increasing awareness and appreciation of traditional foods by reaching wider audiences. This supports the data showing that integrating cultural heritage with modern technology offers a creative solution for sustaining traditional practices. Additionally, respondent seven (7) emphasized that *kiniing* is not only sold in a restaurant for income but also used to teach the younger generation traditional preservation methods, stating “*no awan ti kiniing, awan met ti pangalaan mi ti kanen ken kuarta*” the respondent said, if there is no *kiniing*, they have nothing to eat or earn. These experiences are supported by Magcale-Macandog and Ocampo (2005), who stated that community-based livelihood programs help maintain indigenous practices while supporting sustainable income. Thus, the data shows that for most of the respondents, producing *kiniing* is a meaningful balance of cultural preservation and economic necessity. This is further supported by Garambas et al. (2022), who explained that traditional smoked pork like *kinuday* not only serves as preserved food but also acts as a medium to pass down traditional knowledge within families.

Two (2) out of seven (7) respondents, shared that their decision to produce *kiniing* began as a practical response to both meat preservation and financial necessity. Respondent four (4) explained that the production of *kiniing* started spontaneously after a pig was slaughtered. She shared, “*nuntan nu makdang i parti ni killom wayhakay ni kustumer ni nanghal kantuy ipadas min mangamag ni kiniing isunga diman lan inlugi min kamangamag at hay andi masayang ni karne*” the respondent expressed that their production started after slaughtering a pig, when a buyer came and suggested to smoke the meat or turn it into *kiniing* so it would not go to waste. This shows that the decision was born out of a desire to prevent spoilage and maximize the value of the meat. Without any formal training, the respondent

emphasized that they learned through hands-on experience, using *kiniing* as a practical solution “*tapno saan nga maibasura ti karne*” so the meat would not be thrown away. This reflects how traditional food knowledge is often gained informally through trial and necessity rather than structured education. Respondent two (2), on the other hand, shared a different yet equally grounded story. She said, “*kasinsin ko ti first nga nangrugi daytoy nga negosyo, ken idiaay ko nasuro ti panag aramid ti kiniing. Ngem gapu ta haan da unay nga masango sunga siyak ti nangsublat nga nagmanage*”. The respondent’s cousin was the first one who started this business, and that’s where she learned how to make *kiniing*. But since her cousin couldn’t manage it properly, she eventually took over as the owner of the *kiniing* business. This transition from being an assistant to managing the enterprise marked the beginning of a sustainable livelihood for the respondent. What started as support for a family member eventually became a full-time source of income. The knowledge gained was passed down informally and improved through direct involvement in the work. For both respondents, the main driving forces were practical food preservation and the opportunity to earn a living from it, especially in a setting where refrigeration was limited or unavailable. These narratives support the article by Nordis (2014), which emphasized that in upland areas of the Cordillera, smoked meat products such as *kiniing* are not only cultural practices but also responses to practical limitations, especially the absence of refrigeration. The article explained that *kiniing* served both as a preservation strategy and as a way to secure income, especially during times when fresh meat was at risk of spoilage. This highlights the deep connection between traditional practices and economic survival in indigenous communities.

According to one (1) out of seven (7) respondents, the decision to produce *kiniing* was influenced by community demand and cultural tradition. It was explained, “*mas kayat dagiti kustomer ti kiniing kaysa iti sariwa uno fresh a laman, karkaru dagiti awan ref da, ta ti fresh a karne ket mabangles ken nu aglaok jay angot na iti dadduma nga karga jay ref.*” The respondent stated that their customers prefer *kiniing* over fresh meat, especially those who do not have freezers because fresh meat tends to spoil and mix odors with others. Additionally, elders and parents influenced this decision. This shows that traditional food choices are still shaped by local community preferences and generational influence. This is supported by the Journal of Ethnic Foods (2022), which stated that ethnic foods like *kiniing* are valued not only for practical use in rural households but also for their cultural symbolism during community events.

The data supports the Cultural Sustainability Theory, as it reveals that *kiniing* is being sustained through a balance of traditional inheritance and modern adaptation. Respondents one (1) demonstrated that cultural practices can remain alive through intergenerational knowledge “*manipud idi ubingak agar aramidak ti kiniing*” Since the respondent was a child, she have been making *kiniing*, and through structured programs like Tabano–Omang and the Igorota Foundation. The involvement of youth and digital platforms reflects culture’s dynamic nature and aligns with Soini and Birkeland’s (2014) explanation that cultural sustainability includes both preservation and innovation.

The responses also affirm the Heritage Food Systems Theory, as they show that *kiniing* production draws from local knowledge, community memory, and indigenous resources, integrating these with livelihood strategies. The theory

emphasizes how traditional foodways, like smoking meat for preservation and celebration, are vital to cultural resilience.

Finally, the Foodways Theory is supported, especially in how *kiniing* represents more than food, it reflects identity, memory, and community. Whether driven by need, tourism, or generational practice, the act of making *kiniing* connects individuals to their heritage, customs, and community roles. The theory of foodways by Counihan and Van Esterik (2013) helps explain how these everyday actions express deeper cultural meanings and maintain social structure.

Based on the data, two (2) primary methods of preparation were identified in the production of *kiniing*, salting only and a combination of marination and salting before smoking. These methods show a blend of traditional food preservation techniques, practical experience, and adaptation to environmental challenges.

Four (4) out of seven (7) respondents, stated using a traditional method of salting the meat without marinating it in spices. According to the respondent, this simpler method remains effective for preserving the pork before smoking. Respondent six (6) gave the most detailed explanation, “*asinan mi pay laeng sakbay ti panagpaasok, iwa-en iti pa atiddog ken igigiddan ti panag asin, ibabad ti tallo nga aldaw tapno sumrek unay ti asin iti karne. Kalpasanna, ipaasok mi iti 24 agingga 36 nga oras. Idi, nu malpas nga maipaasok ket ibilag ko pay, ngem gapu ta matutudo tatta ket insardeng ko paylang.*” The respondents said he salt the meat before smoking, slice it into long strips, then rub salt evenly. He store it for up to three days so the salt fully penetrates. After that, they smoke it for 24–36 hours. He used to sun-dry it after, but he stopped because it’s always raining now. This step-by-step method shows how the process is rooted in practicality; salt not only

preserves the meat but also ensures that the product dries out slowly and safely. The storage time before smoking is critical to allow the salt to fully seep into the meat, which helps prevent spoilage and improves the meat's texture and flavor. Respondent two (2) emphasized food safety, stating, "*nu kurang ti asin ti karne ket mabalin daytuy nga maigges,*" which translates to, if the *kiniing* lacks salt, it may attract maggots. This highlights how proper salting is viewed as a protective barrier against spoilage in the absence of refrigeration. This was supported by Respondent three (3), who noted that their process involves only "*panag-asin*" salting followed by "*panagpaasok*" smoking. For them, even without spices, proper salting and smoke exposure are enough to make the product safe and durable. Respondent seven (7) added a cultural insight, "*uray simple laeng dagiti us-usaren mi nga ingredients, asin ken paminta, ti pinaka importante ket maala ti usto nga oras ti panagaramid*", meaning, even if they use only simple ingredients like salt and pepper, what really matters is the correct timing during preparation. This shows that in traditional foodways, mastery of timing and technique is valued just as much as ingredients. Smoking must be done slowly and consistently to achieve the right preservation level and flavor. This reliance on salt and smoking for preservation is consistent with guidance from the United States Department of Agriculture (2023), which explains that salt draws out moisture from the meat and inhibits bacterial growth. Smoking then further dries the product and adds antimicrobial compounds through the wood smoke. This technique, according to the USDA, is especially suitable for areas with limited access to refrigeration like remote Cordilleran communities making it a sustainable and safe way to store meat for long periods.

Three (3) out of seven (7) respondents, shared that they prepare *kiniing* by marinating the meat with local spices like garlic, salt, and pepper in addition to

salting. Respondent four (4) stated, “*ibabad mi nin huta karne talu an min ahin, bawang tan paminta ni hakay malabi nu makdang et hanmi la ikiing di lutuan uno pugon*”, they marinate the meat overnight using salt, garlic, and pepper before smoking it. This overnight marination allows the flavors to seep deep into the meat, giving it a richer and more savory taste. Respondent one (1) added that they use adobo ingredients, showing that they blend traditional smoking with familiar Filipino cooking flavors. This approach adds value to the product not only in terms of taste but also in terms of consumer appeal. It also reflects how traditional food processing has been slightly modified or enhanced based on changing preferences and knowledge of flavor development. Respondent five (5) emphasized the importance of flavor, explaining that this method helps give *kiniing* its unique taste, even when stored without refrigeration. The marinated version of *kiniing* also shows the community’s creativity in food preparation, adapting traditional preservation methods while infusing the meat with spices that make it more palatable and marketable. This method is supported by Garambas et al. (2022), who studied *kinuday*, a traditional smoked pork delicacy similar to *kiniing*. Their research found that marination using ingredients like garlic and pepper contributed to stronger aroma, enhanced flavor, and improved sensory characteristics. The added spices also played a role in food safety and longer shelf life. This confirms that the marinated-and-smoked method, as practiced by some *kiniing* makers, has both cultural and technical advantages in food preservation.

The data supports the Cultural Sustainability Theory, as it reveals how traditional *kiniing* practices are preserved while adapting to changing environments. The continued use of “*panag asin ken panag paasok*” salting and smoking, reflects tradition, while adjustments such as eliminating sun-drying due to “*tutuloy a*

panagtudo” continuous rain demonstrate environmental adaptation. This confirms Soini and Birkeland’s (2014) view that cultural sustainability includes both preservation and innovation.

The data also affirms the Heritage Food Systems Theory, which emphasizes the use of local resources, salt, wood for smoking and generational knowledge. Techniques like marination and smoking are not only culinary acts but also expressions of indigenous ecological knowledge that reflect Benguet's climate, ingredients, and cultural preferences.

Within the Foodways Theory, the emphasis on ingredients like salt, pepper, garlic, and long smoking time like 24 to 36 hours demonstrate more than just preservation, they express cultural identity, values, and craftsmanship. Smoking gives it a special taste, illustrates how food preparation reflects meaning, memory, and cultural storytelling. Food, therefore, is not just nourishment. It is heritage passed down in flavor, form, and fire.

The data supports the Cultural Sustainability Theory, the methods practitioners use show both tradition and contextual adaptation. Salting and smoking are preserved core techniques, while the integration of marination and sun-drying adjustments such as dropping sun-drying due to weather demonstrate adaptive resilience, confirming Soini & Birkeland’s (2014) view on culture’s evolution in response to the environment.

The practices also affirm the Heritage Food Systems Theory, as *kinuday* methods combine local resources salt, wood and empirical knowledge passed through generations observed from elders, highlighting the synergy between food tradition, ecological context, and community-based knowledge systems.

Based on the data, the respondents use different sources of pork for *kiniing* production depending on availability, meat quality, cultural importance, and economic factors. Each choice reflects a balance between tradition and practicality in maintaining this indigenous food practice.

Four (4) out of seven (7) respondents, the preferred source of pork for *kiniing* is commercial pigs, commonly described as white pigs. Respondent one (1) stated, “*agtartaraken kami kadagiti baboy nga puraw ta nalaka mi nga makita iti pagbaboyan mi. Nu partien mi, pilien mi ti liempo ken lomo wennu jay likod ti baboy ta nasam-it ken mayat para iti panag aramid ti kiniing. Ti native a baboy ket bassit laeng ti adda ken narigat a kitaen, isunga commercial a baboy wennu puraw a baboy ti ar-aramaten mi tapno sigurado nga adda ti mausar para iti produksion mi.*” The respondent usually obtained pig meat from farm-raised or white pigs because these were easily available at local pig farms. During slaughter, they selected the pork belly and loin parts to ensure the meat was flavorful and suitable for making *kiniing*. They noted that native pigs were harder to find and insufficient in quantity to meet the demands of *kiniing* production. Also respondent four (4) stated that “*huta amputi ni killom i mika uhalan pang kiing tep haman i nalakan kama hiwang diya kad an mi. Nu way man parti ni hinahgang untunggal kamin per kilo pilian mi huta partes ni belly tep haman i mayat ni ikiing. Nu way lakon buo ni killom, haman i tunggalen mi et hanmi iparti huta adum ni agmi uhalen ni partes man hiyay ilako mi di adum. Nuntan andi pay i hakit ni killom kami kaman taraken ngem nihaya la inhaldang mi. Mayat nu way sarili ni taraken tep mabawasan iday gastos. Mayat matlang kuma i native ngem naligat i panglaan.*” They prefer commercially raised pigs because these are easy to find in their area. When someone is going to slaughter a pig, they buy per kilo and choose the belly parts because they

taste better when used for *kiniing*. In some cases, they also buy a whole pig to slaughter, and the parts that they don't use for *kiniing* are sold to people in their barangay. They used to raise commercial pigs, but they stopped because of ASF African Swine Fever. They believe it is better to have their own pigs because it reduces costs compared to buying from others, where there is usually a high price. But in terms of *kiniing*, they think native pigs or black pigs would be better, but these are difficult to source or hard to find. For this reason, commercial pigs were used to ensure there was enough meat to support their production needs. Respondent six (6) explained that *"In our business ti us-usaren ket commercial pigs. Saan mi a usaren ti native a baboy ta saan a permanente ti supply da ken nalaka laeng ti availability dagiti puraw. Dagiti commercial pigs ket agtultuloy ti kadakkel da ken kasapulan ti quantity para production mi. Aggatang kami ti karne idia market. Ti panag usar iti commercial a baboy, partikular dagiti parte a kas iti liempo, ket mangted iti naisangsangayan a balanse ti taba ken lasag. Ti native pigs ket natipid ken adu ti lean meat, nga agresulta iti dry ken natangtangken ti texture. Para kaniak, awan unay ti nagsabalyan ti raman, ngem no baboy a lalaki, naangot ti raman wennu nalangsi. Nagtaraken ak ti baboy idi, ngem nagsardeng ak gapu ti awan ti tiempo,"* the respondent stated that in their business, they choose to use commercially raised pigs instead of native black pigs for making *kiniing* mainly because of consistency and supply. The commercial pigs also grow faster and are more readily available in the quantities they need. They buy the meat in the market, using commercial pigs, especially cuts like *liempo*, which provides the ideal balance between fat and lean meat. Native pigs have thinner fat layers and more lean meat, resulting in a drier and tougher texture. Commercial pigs are fed properly, giving them balanced fat ideal for *kiniing*. They see no big difference in taste, but boars

tend to smell bad. They used to raise pigs but stopped due to lack of time. This results in *kiniing* that is juicy and uniform in quality. The findings show that using commercial pork helps ensure production efficiency and stable income. This is supported by the U.S. Department of Agriculture (2023), which notes that regulated and uniform meat sources reduce food safety risks and support more predictable smoked meat outputs. Thus, the data reflects that using commercial pigs supports both business and safety while addressing demand.

Two (2) out of seven (7) respondents, shared using both native and commercial pigs, depending on availability and purpose. Based on the answers, native pigs are preferred for the flavor and texture, with respondent two (2) stating that *“us-usaren mi dagiti native a baboy dagiti nangisit ken dagiti commercial a baboy dagiti puraw, depende kadagiti presyo ken availability. Mas kayat mi ti native pigs ta naimas ti raman da, ngem nalak laka ti presyo dagiti commercial pigs. Agparti kami ti maysa nga baboy ken aramiden amin nga parte a kiniing. Ti difference ti native ken commercial pigs ket ti native ket mas nadagdagsen ti karne na, ngem saan nga adu ti supply. Idi pandemya, nagsardeng kami ti babuyan”*, they use both native black pigs and commercially raised white pigs, depending on availability and price. They prefer native pigs when available because of their flavor, but commercial ones are more affordable and easier to find. They slaughter the whole pig and turn all its parts into *kiniing*. The meat of native pigs is heavier and denser than that of white pigs. However, during the pandemic, they had to stop the piggery. This dual sourcing helps these producers adjust to market disruptions like the African Swine Fever or economic impacts during the pandemic. The result suggests that sourcing flexibility helps balance cultural quality and production continuity. Das et al. (2022) emphasized that traditional producers must adapt their

livestock sourcing based on shifting economic or supply conditions, supporting the respondents' strategy. Therefore, the data shows that this method of combining both types of pork enhances production resilience while preserving heritage-based values.

One (1) out of seven (7) respondents, Respondent five (5) shared that exclusively uses native pigs, either raised personally or bought from “*uraga*”, trusted local butchers. According to the response, native pigs are preferred for their strong flavor, texture, and deeper cultural meaning. This respondent emphasized that choosing “*baboy nga nangisit wennu native a baboy*” The black pigs helps maintain the original taste of *kiniing* and protect its cultural value. The statement highlights the priority of heritage over convenience. As supported by Garambas et al. (2022), the use of native pigs and natural ingredients like *bato nga asin* results in more authentic *kinuday* and reinforces the cultural depth of traditional smoked pork. This approach directly reflects the Cultural Sustainability Theory, where practices rooted in indigenous tradition continue despite changing conditions.

The result supports the Cultural Sustainability Theory, as meat sourcing reflects how producers adapt while maintaining cultural integrity. Four out of seven respondents select commercial pigs for efficiency and stability, but one out of seven continues to use native pigs for cultural authenticity, illustrating that traditions can survive by modifying materials but keeping values intact (Soini & Birkeland, 2014).

The findings also support the Heritage Food Systems Theory, as sourcing decisions involve both ecological and cultural reasoning, choosing between “*uraga*” and market suppliers reflects community-based food systems that uphold identity and memory while ensuring continuity.

Finally, the Foodways Theory is reflected in the symbolic meaning of pork choice. The selection of native pork for rituals or tradition, and commercial pork for business, represents how food decisions communicate identity and adapt to economic realities. As Counihan and Van Esterik (2013) emphasize, foodways are everyday cultural acts that express community structure and values.

Based on the data, all seven (7) respondents consistently preferred alnus wood for smoking *kiniing*. The result shows that alnus is highly valued for its ability to produce better flavor and aroma, “*raman ken angot*”. According to the responses, this wood type not only enhances the sensory qualities of the meat but also reflects a strong cultural tradition passed down through generations. All respondents shared, “*masapul ti alnus a kayo ta adda mayat nga raman ken angot na*” the respondents said that alnus wood is needed because it gives a good taste and aroma. Respondent four (4) also referred to this practice as “*tradisyonal naka ugalyan mi ti panag usar ti alnus*” the respondent said that it was traditionally used in our community. Thus, the data shows that all the respondents associate the use of alnus not only with superior taste and smell but also with cultural identity and authenticity. This is supported by the findings of Garambas et al. (2022), who emphasized that traditional Benguet smoked pork products like *kinuday* are commonly smoked using alnus wood due to its effect on aroma, texture, and flavor. The researchers found that alnus smoke contributes to a firmer texture and richer smoky flavor, improving the overall sensory appeal of the meat. This supports the respondents’ belief that alnus is the best wood for smoking *kiniing*.

While alnus is the most preferred, five (5) out of seven (7) respondents, stated using guava wood as a secondary option, depending on availability. Respondent seven (7) stated, “*usaren mi met ti bayabas no awan ti alnus ta addaan*

banglo ken imas ti raman metlang daytoy” the respondent also use guava wood when alnus is not available because it also has a fragrant smell and good flavor. Respondent four (4) added that guava “*nu agtultuloy ti panag pa asok ket mangted daytoy iti banglo ti karne*” the respondent said that if the smoking continues, it gives the meat a pleasant aroma. Based on the result, guava is considered a trusted substitute that can still deliver desirable flavor outcomes. This is supported by research published by the King of Foods Blog (2024), which stated that guava wood emits a light, fruity aroma that enhances the flavor of smoked meats. The article also noted that guava burns at a stable rate and does not produce harsh smoke, making it ideal for slow smoking. This supports the respondents’ claims about the effectiveness of guava as a practical and flavorful alternative to alnus.

Other types of wood such as pine, *kallahan*, *palayen* or oak tree, and even charcoal were also mentioned by respondent four (4), five (5) and six (6) but only as alternatives and with cautious use. Respondent three (3) and four (4) explained that pine wood is used only “*nu awan ti alnus*” or if there’s no alnus and warned that “*nu masobran iti pangpa asok ket agited ti raman nga napait*” or if the smoking is overdone, it gives a bitter taste. Respondent four (4) observed that *kallahan* wood “*man balin ni kulay reddish huta kiniing*” or it creates a reddish color in the meat. Respondent five (5) mentioned *palayen* or oak tree as a last resort during shortages, stating “*mangted iti moderate heat ken awan unay ti angot wenno banglo ti asok na*”, the respondent stated that it produces moderate heat and neutral smoke. The result shows that these alternatives are only used during shortages and are considered risky. These observations are supported by scientific research. Ruiz, R., Santos, V., & Marzocchi, M. (2021) This study shows that pine wood has natural chemicals, like resin acids and phenols, that can make smoked meat taste bitter and

look darker. Nizio, Ewa, Czwartkowski, Krzysztof, & Niedbała, Grzegorz. (2023). This article reviews how various smoking materials, including softwoods affect PAH levels in smoked foods, confirming that softwoods can elevate health and sensory risks.

The responses of the *kiniing* makers strongly reflect the Cultural Sustainability Theory, which emphasizes the importance of retaining cultural practices while adapting to modern needs. The consistent use of alnus wood not only preserves the authentic flavor of *kiniing* but also symbolizes a living tradition. As alnus is deeply tied to local knowledge and generational practice, it serves as a marker of cultural identity.

This also supports the Heritage Food Systems Theory, as the use of specific wood types like alnus and guava reflects the use of local ecological resources rooted in the landscape of Benguet. This ties food production to the environment, community, and culture. Choosing guava as a substitute when alnus is unavailable shows flexibility without detaching from traditional standards.

Moreover, the respondents' choosing wood that doesn't make too much smoke or smell woods like pines supports the Foodways Theory, which emphasizes the meaning and value embedded in every food decision. Smoking wood is not just fuel; it represents taste, memory, health, and cultural values. These choices show how traditional food production balances safety, taste, and identity.

Thus, the data is supported by all three (3) theories, cultural traditions (Cultural Sustainability), environmental context (Heritage Food Systems), and symbolic social meaning (Foodways). This proves that wood choice in *kiniing* production is not random, it is deeply cultural, practical, and purposeful.

Based on the data, different smoking processes are used in producing *kiniing*, with most of the respondents favoring closed-type systems due to their benefits in controlling smoke, heat, and cleanliness.

For six (6) out of seven (7) respondents, the preferred method is a closed-area, drum-type smoking process. According to the responses, this method is more effective in preventing contamination, improving hygiene, and maintaining consistent heat and smoke levels. Respondent two (2) described the process “*ag usar kami iti closed area or drum type tapno saan a maka uneg dagiti langaw ken insecto*” the respondent use a closed area or drum type smoker so that flies and insects cannot get inside. The respondent also explained, “*masapul a kitkitan a nasayaat ti proseso ti panagpa-asok ken maaramid daytoy ti stainless steel a drum a mabalin pagi kargaan kadagiti ad-adu a piraso ti karne*” the respondent explained that the smoking process must be watched closely and described using a stainless steel drum that can hold several cuts of meat. Respondent six (6) who has a background in nursing, shifted to using a closed smoker after experiencing issues with maggots, stating, “*nagserbi nga dayta ti rason ta adda idi ti nagtubo nga igges ken adu dagiti langaw rason daytoy nga maapektaran ti raman ti karne*” the respondent stated that it served as the reason because maggots grew and there were many flies, which affected the taste of the meat. This respondent emphasized that the enclosed drum now helps retain heat more effectively, resulting in better-quality *kiniing*. The result shows that most of the respondents prefer closed smokers to ensure hygiene, consistent product quality, and safer production. This is supported by the findings from ScienceDirect (2024), which emphasized that enclosed systems allow better smoke distribution, heat control, and reduced environmental contamination. Thus, the data shows that traditional methods are now being adapted

to meet food safety needs, while still preserving the core smoking technique, which supports the Cultural Sustainability Theory discussed.

Among those who use closed-type drum smokers, respondent one (1) also mentioned their reason for preferring this method, saying, “*ag usar kami ti drum-type tapno nalaklaka nga apan ijay karne jay asok ken tapno ag naim imas ti raman na*” the respondent use a drum-type smoker so that the smoke can easily reach the meat and to enhance its flavor. The respondent three (3) shared that this method “*tumulong nga makontrol ti pudot ken asok na*” it helps control the heat and the smoke. Similarly, respondent six (6) explained that “*nalak laka nga ikontrol ken mas agtalinaed ti usto nga pudot na,*” it is easier to control, and the heat stays at the right level, especially during bad weather. The result shows that the drum-type setup provides both convenience and efficiency in producing *kiniing*. This is supported by the Environmental Health Services HACCP (Washoe County Health District, 2023) guidelines, which state that enclosed smokehouses help prevent cross-contamination and ensure even heat and smoke flow, making the method suitable for both traditional use and modern hygiene standards.

In contrast, one out of seven (7) respondents, respondent four (4) continues to use an open-area smoking method known as *pugon*. This respondent explained, “*pugon i mika uhalan kamangi ki-ing, tep hiyay nabayag lan mika ipah pahding,*” the respondent explained they use a furnace with rice husks to smoke the *kiniing*, because it can be used for a long time during the smoking process. According to the respondent, this traditional method gives the meat a more balanced texture and an authentic smoky flavor. This is supported by Morton’s Farm (2023), which stated that open-fire or traditional smoking methods provide a distinctive rustic flavor and mouthfeel that many consumers associate with authenticity. Although this method

lacks the controlled environment of enclosed systems, the result shows that it is still preferred by those aiming to preserve the original taste and texture of *kiniing*. This supports the Cultural Sustainability Theory, which highlights that maintaining traditional methods, even with modern alternatives available, plays a critical role in safeguarding cultural food heritage.

The widespread adoption of closed-area drum smokers demonstrates cultural innovation aligned with the Cultural Sustainability Theory, producers are integrating modern techniques to preserve smoked meat traditions in safer and more scalable ways while keeping the cultural essence intact. Meanwhile, the retention of the open-area *pugon* option reflects a deliberate choice to maintain sensory and available materials cultural authenticity, suggesting resilience and layered practice.

Under the Heritage Food Systems Theory, both methods draw on locally, metal drums, firewood, or *pugon* and embody the interplay of community knowledge and food safety practices. This indicates a system where tradition and modern adaptation coexist to ensure food production remains viable and culturally meaningful.

From the Foodways Theory, the way people smoke meat reflects their community's identity and what they value. Using a closed smoker shows that they are focused on business, safety, and clean production. On the other hand, using a traditional *pugon* open fire oven shows a connection to rituals, taste, and culture. These different methods, though not the same, both show how making food is not just about cooking it also shows tradition, flavor, and what matters to the people.

In terms of duration, the data shows that the majority of respondents follow a specific time frame to ensure flavor, texture, and food safety. For five (5) out of seven (7) respondents, the *kiniing* smoking process typically lasts one to two (2)

days 24–48 hours. According to the responses, this duration helps achieve the desired level of preservation, aroma, and texture. Respondent five (5) shared, “*naidumduma a raman ti maala nu dua nga aldaw ti panagpaasok. Tapno maala ti mayat a kinapudot ken kinabanglo na,*” emphasizing that the two (2)-day process allows proper drying and smoke absorption, especially in places where there is no access to refrigeration. Respondent two (2) stressed the importance of smoking for food safety, stating, “*nu nabiit lang nga ipaasok, ket nalaka nga maiggesan,*” if it’s smoked for too short a time, maggots may appear. Respondent six (6) supported this timeframe as well, adding that extended smoking may lead to bitterness, but 24–48 hours achieve the best balance “*nu atiddog ti oras ti panagpaasok, ag ited daytoy ti napait nga raman na isunga maysa ken dua nga aldaw ti ar aramiden mi nga ag pa asok,*” the respondent said that the longer smoking times tend to produce a bitter aftertaste and cause the meat to darken. Two other respondents, respondent four (4) and five (5), also confirmed following the same duration due to traditional practice and their observation of desired texture and smoky aroma. The result shows that most of the respondents rely on ancestral timing, usually one (1) to two (2) days to achieve flavor depth, firmness, and proper preservation. This practice is supported by the study of Garambas et al. (2022), which found that smoking for 24–36 hours allows better smoke penetration, resulting in stronger aroma, firmer texture, and longer shelf life of smoked pork products like *kinuday*. This supports the Cultural Sustainability Theory presented, which states that traditional practices are often based on practical, experience-based knowledge that aligns with scientific food safety and preservation methods.

One (1) out of seven (7) respondents, described a shorter duration of overnight smoking, or up to three (3) days when demand is low. According to the

respondent seven (7) response, “*adu ti mangkayat nga mangan ti kiniing isunga i-overnight mi laengen ti panag paasok,*” the respondent said that lots of customer want kiniing, so they stay overnight just to smoke the meat. This respondent also noted that the original method lasted for three (3) days but was shortened to respond to current market needs. The result shows that this practice reflects strategic adaptation, where the smoking time is reduced to meet higher customer demand while still preserving flavor and quality through close monitoring. This approach is supported by food preservation literature that modern smoking technologies can reduce processing time while still achieving preservation and flavor as long as heat is properly controlled and monitored. This supports the respondent’s claim that a shorter smoking period is still effective when paired with modern enclosed equipment and careful observation.

Another one (1) out of seven (7) respondents, respondent three (3) shared that their smoking process takes only four (4) to five (5) hours, which is much shorter than the typical duration of 24 to 36 hours mentioned by other respondents. According to the respondent, “*agpaasok kami ti uppat uno lima nga oras ta nabibiit laeng nga malako ta adakami iti igid ti kalsada,*” the respondent only smoke the meat for around four to five (5) hours so it’s easier to sell quickly since they are located along the road. This shorter smoking duration reflects a production strategy focused on immediate selling rather than long-term preservation. Because their business is located beside the highway, there is steady foot traffic and easy access for customers. Smoking the meat quickly allows for faster turnover of products, making it more efficient for daily sales. However, this approach also shows a compromise between traditional preservation and modern market demands. While longer smoking times result in better drying and extended shelf life, this respondent

prioritizes convenience, speed, and marketability. The meat may be less preserved in the long term, but this trade-off is acceptable because it is sold the same day or shortly after production. This demonstrates a practical adaptation of traditional techniques to suit commercial conditions highlighting how location, customer behavior, and time availability shape production methods. This marketing-based adaptation is supported by the findings of Guerrero, Jun, and Jeong (2022), who discussed how small-scale meat processors often adjust traditional food preparation techniques depending on customer access and sales location. In fast-selling areas like roadside markets, producers tend to shorten preparation times in favor of quantity and speed. Although this may reduce the product's shelf life, the immediacy of sales reduces the need for extended preservation.

This is supported by meat science literature, which highlights that short-duration smoking results in milder flavor and shorter shelf life, making it ideal only for meat that will be consumed within 24 hours. Thus, the data shows that this method involves a trade-off between speed and depth of flavor, with preservation being secondary to market responsiveness.

These findings demonstrate cultural adaptation aligned with Cultural Sustainability Theory. The dominant one (1)–two (2) day smoking process reflects continuity in traditional knowledge, while adaptations to shorter or longer durations reflect practical flexibility. The result is a living tradition that evolves alongside market and resource dynamics.

This pattern also supports Heritage Food Systems Theory, where smoking duration is shaped by ecological and economic conditions, weather, firewood availability, demand levels underscoring how indigenous food practices are integrated into local systems and continue to evolve in response to changing needs.

According to Foodways Theory, the specific timing of smoking is both a practical and symbolic marker of culinary identity. A one (1)–two (2) day duration represents authenticity and proper preparation; overnight or four (4)–five (5)-hour smoking methods reflect pragmatic adjustments while maintaining cultural flavor. Thus, smoking duration itself becomes a cultural signifier, reflecting community and market identities.

It was presented and discussed in the second section that producers experienced challenges in preserving *kiniing* while meeting consumer expectations. These include the rising cost of pigs, difficulty in sourcing materials, changing consumer preferences, and handling market competition, all of which affect the continuity and sustainability of the tradition.

Five (5) out of seven (7) respondents, shared that they adjust the selling price of *kiniing* depending on the cost of pigs in the market. They explained that this is necessary to cover production expenses and maintain profit, especially since pork is the main ingredient. Respondent two (2) explained, “*nu nababa ti presyo ti karne, ti kiniing ket mabalin nga mas gatangen dagiti turista ken umili,*” which means if the pork price is lower, then the *kiniing* would also cost less, so tourists and locals could afford it. This illustrates a direct relationship between raw material cost and product price. Respondent six (6) said they are “*napilitan a mangi ngato ti presyo,*” forced to raise the price of *kiniing* when pork prices go up, or else they risk losing money. Likewise, respondent three (3) stated that “*masapul ko met nga ingato ti presyo ti kiniing ko, tapno maibasar iti presyo ti dadduma*” the respondent said that they also need to increase the price of *kiniing* based on the current market price. and “*nu tatta nga nangina ti karne 420 diay fresh per kilo ngem nu ikiing i timbang mi bago ikiing 450 kasjay, nu bumaba ket ag 350 ti fresh karne nu ikiing mi 380*

basta agpatong kmi 30 pesos”. At present, fresh pork costs ₱420 per kilo, but when made into *kiniing*, it is sold at ₱450 per kilo. If the price of fresh pork drops to ₱350, the *kiniing* is then sold at ₱380, they simply add ₱30 as a markup. These statements reflect a common financial strategy among small-scale producers to remain sustainable. They don’t raise prices without reason; they change them based on how much supply is available and the cost of getting the meat. Respondent one (1) also said the same, the high price of pork forces them to raise the *kiniing* price to maintain profitability. Respondent seven (7) noted that “*maminsan ket bumaba iti sales, ta dagiti turista ket mangin nginaan da iti price iti kiniing or maminsan ket bassit lang gatangen da,*” the respondent said that this sometimes leads to slower sales since tourists may find the product expensive and end up buying less. This pricing strategy is supported by Guerrero, Santos, and Cruz (2024), who found that consumer preferences for traditional food products are closely tied to affordability. When input costs rise, such as pork, customers may choose cheaper alternatives, which impacts the viability of traditional producers. This shows that pricing adjustments are not purely for profit, but a survival strategy in the face of fluctuating costs.

Respondents four (4), shared that rising pig prices not only affect pricing but also limit access to good-quality meat. Respondent four (4) expressed a strong concern, “*nilikna mi i ligat ni kapahding ni ka untunggal ni pahad ni klase ni karne nu nangingay presyo tu, isunga kapilitan dama ni i ngina mi presyon kiniing. Nu man stidin nangingay karne agkamila mangam mag ni kiniing. Tep huta kina baba muwan ni presyo ni karne man hiya matlang i rason nu kalay ni nababa ikalidad ni karne. Hutada nababay presyon karne tu man haman ida huta ag na aywanan ni usto uno kulang i daka ipakan. Haya iday rason nu kalay wada lattay nababan kalidad ni*

karne isunga mabalin ni apektaran tu kas kuma huta linmungkay ni karne tan na andi lay amih tu,” the respondent said that they encountered difficulty in affording good-quality pigs because of the high price, and needed to increase the selling price of *kiniing*. If the price of pigs is too high, then she will not produce *kiniing*. The reason why the price of pig is low is also the reason why the meat quality is low. Pigs that are sold at low prices are usually not raised properly. They might be given poor-quality feeds, not taken care of well, and not raised for the right amount of time before being sold. Because of this, the meat becomes low in quality, it may be soft, watery, or not tasty. This affects the quality of the *kiniing*. This challenge emphasizes that raw material quality directly impacts the quality of traditional products, and cutting costs by buying cheap pork leads to reduced flavor, poor texture, and customer dissatisfaction. Garcia and Lubag (2022) supported this concern, stating that the quality, flavor, and physicochemical properties of traditional smoked meat like *kinuday* heavily depend on the quality of raw pork. Poor-quality inputs compromise the sensory profile and shelf life of the final product. This supports the respondents' fear that sourcing cheaper pork negatively affects product authenticity and consumer trust.

Lastly, respondent five (5) shared a concern about how pricing changes affect customer behavior. Unlike others who raise their prices based on pork costs, Respondent five (5) explained that they prefer to maintain a fair price “*umno nga presyo*” to avoid losing customers. The respondent expressed worry that if the product becomes too expensive, “*bassit iti gumatang*”, states that a few would buy. This fear is based on their observation that both locals and tourists have limited budgets and may no longer choose *kiniing* if it becomes too costly. The respondent's solution is to maintain balance covering expenses while still keeping the product

affordable for loyal buyers. This shows a problem, producers need to raise prices to earn enough, but if the price is too high, customers might stop buying. This can lower interest in *kiniing* and put the tradition at risk. The Slow Food Foundation (2023) highlighted that rising input costs and consumer affordability are two (2) of the main threats to small-scale traditional food producers. When product prices rise due to raw material costs, many consumers opt for industrialized or cheaper alternatives. This makes it harder for heritage foods like *kiniing* to survive in the market unless a pricing balance is maintained.

When the budget is tight, some producers might reduce smoking time, skip steps, or use lower-quality meat without proper inspection. This compromises the hygiene, safety, and cultural authenticity of *kiniing*. According to the USDA Food Safety and Inspection Service (2024), food safety in smoked meat depends on consistent temperature control, smoking duration, and meat quality. Economic pressures that result in shortcutting any of these stages increase the risk of bacterial growth and food spoilage. Therefore, maintaining traditional methods under financial stress is not only a cultural issue but a public health concern as well.

The data reveal that producers of *kiniing* encountered serious economic pressure due to the rising cost of pigs, affecting not only pricing but also product quality, safety, and consumer accessibility. This financial burden is leading to difficult decisions, raising prices and risk losing buyers, or use lower-quality ingredients and risk damaging tradition. The Cultural Sustainability Theory is strongly supported, as the respondents demonstrate attempts to adapt their practices through pricing adjustments and quality compromises to keep the tradition alive. The Heritage Food Systems Theory is also validated, showing how reliance on native or quality ingredients is vital to maintaining traditional identity, even though

economic constraints may threaten this. Furthermore, the Foodways Theory is affirmed, as the data reflect how food practices are shaped by economic realities, and that market conditions deeply influence both the production and perception of traditional foods. These theoretical alignments underscore the delicate balance producers must maintain between economic survival and cultural preservation.

Based on the data, three (3) out of seven (7) respondents, stated that there is no difficulty in sourcing essential materials for *kiniing*, as these are readily available in their local area. Respondent two (2) explained that although packaging is not a personal problem, “*mas nasaysayaat no adda sticker ti packaging da tapno napintas ti presentation na,*” it would be better if other producers placed stickers on their packaging to improve presentation. The respondent emphasized that consumer expectations are changing, with some buyers preferring *kiniing* that looks more professional or modern. Respondent three (3), who operates a roadside business, stated, “*adakami iti igid ti kalsada isunga nalaka nga malako ti kiniing mi ken maysa pay saan mi nga ipakete ta isupay ti masayang nga oras,*” they are located by the highway so it’s easy to sell our *kiniing*, and they don’t package it anymore because it just wastes time. This indicates that location can reduce the need for extra packaging, especially in high-traffic areas. Respondent five (5) likewise mentioned that materials are accessible and pose no challenge. Meanwhile, Respondent six (6) shared that “*ti kiniing mi ket naka-vacuum seal tapno bumayag ti biag na, nasurok a 15days nu adda laeng iti kwarto, 30 days nu naka chill, ken mas atiddog pay no naifreezer,*” the respondents *kiniing* is vacuum-sealed to extend shelf life up to 15 days at room temperature, 30 days or one (1) month if chilled, and even longer when frozen. This shows how modern packaging techniques are being integrated with traditional methods to meet food safety standards and market

demands. These packaging practices are aligned with the Fondazione Slow Food Ark of Taste (2023), which emphasized that better branding and packaging of heritage foods like *kiniing* not only preserve cultural identity but also increase market competitiveness. Additionally, Baylor College of Medicine (2024) supports the use of vacuum-sealing, confirming that it extends the shelf life of smoked meats by preventing moisture loss and bacterial growth, thus protecting both flavor and safety.

Three (3) out of seven (7) respondents, shared difficulties related to sourcing preferred types of wood for smoking, particularly *alhus* and *guava*. These woods are known to impart a distinct aroma and flavor to the meat. Respondent two (2) shared, “*gapu iti limitado nga supply kadagiti kakaykayuan ken nangato presyo ti kayo, napilitan kami nga agusar ti pine trees,*” because of the limited supply and high cost of the usual smoking woods, we are forced to use pine as an alternative. While pine is available, it is considered a less ideal substitute, potentially altering the meat’s authentic flavor. Respondent four (4) also noted that “*dakel i problema tep nu un ali typhoon agkami maka alan kiyaw ni uhalan min mangi kiing ni karne, isunga mas pahad nu naka plano ka uno insasaganam i uhalan mu ni mangi kiing,*” respondent said that typhoons make it difficult to gather wood, especially when transportation routes are affected. Respondent six (6) added that finding legal or sustainable wood has become harder due to environmental restrictions and forest depletion. These responses reflect not only supply limitations but also the tension between sustainability and tradition. The *Journal of Ethnic Foods* (2022) confirms that specific wood types greatly affect the sensory qualities of smoked meats. Changing the wood used can alter the flavor and aroma, reducing cultural authenticity. This supports the respondents’ concern and reflects the Heritage Food

Systems Theory, which stresses the importance of using locally appropriate and traditional materials to preserve food identity and cultural heritage.

One (1) out of seven (7) respondents, respondent seven (7) highlighted that “*panag ngina ti presyo ti kayo ken baboy*,” the high price of wood and pork, is making *kiniing* production more expensive and labor-intensive. This indicates that producers are now facing economic strain across multiple resources, not just one. The rising cost of both wood and meat increases the overall burden of production, which may discourage traditional practice due to its low financial viability. This issue is supported by a review published by *ScienceDirect* (2024), which explains that the rising costs of raw materials and limited resource availability are key challenges for traditional meat producers worldwide. As materials become more expensive and harder to find, many small-scale artisans struggle to sustain traditional practices.

One (1) out of seven (7) respondents, respondent one (1) discussed an infrastructure-related challenge, stating that “*nalipit jay lugar nqa pag ar-aramidan mi ti kiniing, isunga narigat ti panagtrabaho, kinadalus, ken food safety*,” the processing space is small, making it hard to work efficiently, maintain cleanliness, and ensure food safety. This shows that beyond materials, the physical working environment also affects production quality. Small or unhygienic spaces may limit productivity and raise food safety concerns, especially when producing in larger quantities. The USDA Food Safety and Inspection Service (FSIS) (2024) emphasizes that sufficient and sanitary workspaces are essential in traditional meat processing. Clean environments help prevent contamination, maintain product safety, and comply with public health standards. The lack of adequate processing space thus poses a real risk not only to product quality but also to consumer safety.

The data indicate that while most producers have access to core materials like pork and basic packaging, significant challenges emerge in obtaining appropriate smoking woods, modern packaging tools, and hygienic processing facilities. These challenges impact product quality, authentic flavor, presentation, food safety, and ultimately, consumer acceptance. The findings corroborate the Heritage Food Systems Theory, which highlights the importance of local, culturally appropriate ingredients and adequate processing infrastructure, for the preservation of traditional cuisine. They also align with the Foodways Theory, demonstrating that material availability and production environments influence both food practice and cultural meaning. Finally, responses about packaging modernization and infrastructure improvement reflect the principles of Cultural Sustainability Theory, as adaptation through enhancement of presentation and hygiene supports cultural resilience and economic sustainability. Together, these results suggest that preserving *kiniing* requires not only cultural knowledge but also strategic upgrades in resource access, infrastructure, and packaging to ensure both tradition and safety endure in changing markets.

Based on the data, three (3) out of seven (7) respondents, respondent one (1) shared that “*napigsa a kompetision manipud kadagiti commercial ken imported a produkto ti karne, kas kadagiti brand manipud sabali a probinsia ken ilako da daytoy iti nababa a presyo,*” strong competition from commercial and imported meat products, particularly those branded from other provinces and sold at lower prices. Respondent three (3) remarked that “*napardas ti kompetensia kadagiti commercial wenno imported nga produkto gapu ta nalaklaka, dagiti farmers nga ad-adu ti galansiyada iti panaglakoda iti nateng ket gumatgatang da iti ad-adu a kiniing no kaya da,*” competition with commercial or imported products is growing

fast because these are often cheaper or more accessible; farmers who earn more from selling crops tend to buy more *kiniing* if they can afford it, highlighting that consumer income plays a significant role in purchasing decisions. These responses show that local *kiniing* producers must adapt their pricing and marketing to remain viable amid a growing influx of mass-produced and lower-priced alternatives. This matches findings by ScienceDirect (2024), which states that traditional food producers are increasingly displaced by mass-produced products that are cheaper, more consistent, and better distributed. The decline in demand caused by mainstream products supports the respondents' experience and highlights how affordability and product access determine market competitiveness. It also underscores the role of changing economic conditions in altering consumer foodways, particularly in rural and farming communities where income is seasonal and sales fluctuate with harvest cycles.

Another group of three (3) out of seven (7) respondents, indicated no difficulty in selling *kiniing*, Respondent five (5) stating “*awan, ta amin a maiproseso ken maaramid ket malakuan,*” the respondent has no difficulty in selling *kiniing* because all that we process is needed and everything we produce is sold. Respondent two (2) explained that “*mostly dagiti kostumer mi ket farmers, gumatang da ti adu nga kiniing nu nangato ti galasiyada iti mula da,*” the respondents customers are mostly farmers who buy more *kiniing* when their vegetable harvest earns more profit. Another respondent highlighted that restaurant presence and highway visibility ensure consistent sales, even without the use of modern packaging or large-scale marketing. These responses illustrate how community-based economic cycles support the local *kiniing* market. The success of *kiniing* in these cases is tied to location advantage, strong buyer familiarity, and

consistent customer loyalty, especially in farming towns where traditional food remains popular. These observations are supported by regional consumer behavior research from ScienceDirect (2024), which notes that in agricultural communities, interest in traditional foods increases when local economic conditions improve. The *Journal of Ethnic Foods* (2022) similarly found that demand for traditional foods spikes in times of local prosperity, showing how food purchasing patterns are tied to agricultural income and local economic health.

Respondent seven (7) emphasized that restaurant-based distribution and generous servings set their *kiniing* apart from competitors, allowing it to stand out despite external competition. This reflects how value-added strategies, such as increasing portion size and emphasizing taste, can help sustain customer loyalty. The respondent's approach highlights the use of product differentiation in terms of both flavor and experience, which is especially important when competing against mass-produced goods. In alignment with this, Garcia and Lubag (2022) observed that consumers prefer kinuday for its superior aroma, smoky flavor, and unique texture, attributes often missing in mass-produced alternatives. This supports the notion that regional and artisanal quality can be a reliable market differentiator, reinforcing the importance of strong cultural flavor profiles and generous presentation. Respondent seven (7) also stated competition from other restaurants but maintained that *kiniing* continues to sell based on taste and portion size, saying “*napigsa ti kompetision kadagiti dadduma nga restaurant, ngem nalaka laeng latta ti panaglako mi iti kiniing gapu ta ammo dagiti tattao ti raman ken kina adu ti servings mi,*” the respondent said that there is strong competition from other restaurants, but we still sell easily because customers know the flavor and the large servings we offer. This insight suggests that sensory satisfaction and quantity

remain strong selling points for traditionally made *kiniing*. Despite modern competitors, authenticity and customer familiarity with traditional flavor give artisanal *kiniing* a competitive edge. This echoes the position described by Zigzag Weekly (2022), which emphasized that *kiniing*-making is a cultural practice, and the methods and flavors used cannot be easily replicated by commercial producers. The flavor profile, rooted in tradition, is not just a recipe but a community-based identity, helping preserve customer loyalty.

The responses highlight the presence of varied market conditions, while large-scale commercial and imported products pose affordability challenges, particularly for price-sensitive consumers, several producers continue to thrive thanks to strong local demand, strategic location, and deep cultural authenticity. These findings align with the Foodways Theory, demonstrating that food trends are shaped by both resource access and economic conditions, and that cultural and sensory qualities can sustain marketability. They also reinforce the Cultural Sustainability Theory, highlighting how adapting the presentation, portion size, and distribution strategies can support tradition in a competitive market. Furthermore, the impact of income cycles such as crop sales on sales of *kiniing* underscores the importance of community-aligned practices, supporting both Heritage Food Systems Theory and Foodways Theory, and illustrating how economic resilience and cultural continuity are mutually reinforcing.

Based on the data, four (4) out of seven (7) respondents, stated encountering strong competition from other *kiniing* makers who sell at lower prices, offer smaller servings, or use fewer ingredients. Respondent one (1) shared, “*adu ti agaramid ti kiniing dito, isunga masapul a mangted ti nadumaduma a raman ken kalidad tapno gumatang dagiti costumer*”, the respondent said that many people make *kiniing*

here, so it is important to offer unique flavors and good quality to attract customers. Respondent three (3) explained, *“masapul nga ibaba ti presyo tapno makipag kompetensia, ngem bumaba ti profit mi,”* the respondent need to lower the price to stay competitive, but their profit decreases. Respondent two (2) emphasize quality over price, *“adda dagiti sabali nga agar aramid iti kiniing a mangilako iti nababa a presyo, ngem agstick ak latta iti pricing ko ta no babaak jay price, saan ko nga mabawi dagiti gastos ko. Jay quality ladtan ti kitan mi kaysa babaan ti presyo,”* the respondent said that there are other *kiniing* makers who sell at cheaper prices, but she stick to my pricing because if she lower it, then she won't be able to recover my expenses. I focus on quality rather than competing through low prices. Lastly, respondent four (4) observed that competitors often cut ingredients or portion size, *“huta adum nu man lako dan kiniing man daka ibabay presyo da, tep kulang i ingredients ni inuhal da han bassit i daka ipalaw ni pang ingridients dan kiniing,”* the respondent said that other *kiniing* sellers have to lower prices because they use fewer ingredients or give smaller portions. These insights are supported by Smith (2023), who noted that artisanal food producers often face intense price competition from mass or budget producers, compelling them to emphasize quality, unique recipes, or portion sizes to maintain market share. This aligns directly with respondents' strategies to remain competitive by protecting their product's quality and value rather than reducing price. Additionally, Reyes and Cruz (2022) observed that private traditional food producers often preserve profit margins by differentiating their offerings rather than engaging in price wars, further validating the choices these producers make to sustain tradition and viability.

One (1) out of seven (7) respondents, respondent seven (7) noted competition exists but stated that their product still attracts customers due to its

superior taste and size, “*adu ti aglako ti kiniing dito, ngem mabalin makalako kami gapu ti naimas a raman ken dakdakkal ti servings mi nga kayat ti customer,*” the respondent said that many people sell kiniing, but they are still able to sell because of the delicious taste and large servings that customers like. This demonstrates a strategic emphasis on sensory appeal and generous portions as a competitive advantage. This perspective is supported by Garcia and Lubag (2022), who highlighted that consumers of *kinuday* prefer the product for its superior aroma, smoky flavor, and unique texture, characteristics not commonly found in commercially processed meats. This matches the respondent’s assertion that aroma, taste, and portion make their *kiniing* stand out, confirming that cultural authenticity and sensory differentiation can offset price-based competition.

Two (2) out of seven (7) respondents, shared experiencing no competition in their locality. Respondent five (5) said, “*dakami laeng ti agar aramid ti kiniing dito barangay isunga awan ti ka-kompetensia mi,*” the respondent are the only ones making kiniing in this barangay, so they have no competition, indicating complete exclusivity in production within their area. This suggests that the respondent benefits from a localized monopoly, where there is no direct competition, allowing them to sell their products without the pressure of competing prices or product substitution. Their position provides market security, enabling them to continue their traditional practices without needing to compromise quality or lower costs. The other respondent, respondent six (6), remarked, “*awan ti problema mi ta adu ti customer mi manipud sabali a lugar,*” which means the respondent don’t have any problem because we have many customers from different places, showing that strong and diverse customer demand, especially from areas beyond the local community, shields them from market pressure. This means their

kiniing is already established and trusted across a wider region, reducing the need to compete with lower-priced or commercialized versions. This situation not only stabilizes their sales but also strengthens their market presence without altering their traditional preparation methods. This scenario reflects the Cultural Sustainability Theory, which suggests that cultural identity and localized monopoly can buffer traditional food producers from external market disruption. Because there is little to no competition and strong consumer loyalty, producers like Respondents five (5) and six (6) are able to preserve the integrity of their traditional methods while maintaining economic viability. It also reinforces findings by Lopez and Morales (2021), who found that market-based forces can erode traditional food practices unless producers implement strong heritage strategies such as maintaining authenticity, reinforcing cultural identity, and building community-based consumer trust. These respondents demonstrate this principle clearly by relying on their unique regional status and consistent demand to preserve tradition and sustain their livelihoods, without having to reduce prices or adopt commercial practices.

The data indicate a multi-faceted competitive landscape for *kiniing* producers. Five (5) respondents active market pressure from lower-priced sellers and must differentiate via quality, flavor, and portion size to protect tradition and revenue. One (1) producer leverages sensory appeal to retain customers. Two (2) benefit from being the only *kiniing* producer in their area, maintaining tradition and price integrity unhindered.

These findings support the Cultural Sustainability Theory, highlighting how cultural practices can remain viable through strategic adaptation, maintaining product essence while responding to competitive pressures. The Heritage Food Systems Theory is affirmed, as producers emphasize authentic taste and portion as

heritage markers resistant to commodification. Lastly, Foodways Theory is validated, showing how market forces, consumer preferences, and cultural identity together shape the sustainability and presentation of traditional foods like *kiniing*.

It was presented and discussed in the third section that sustaining the preservation of *kiniing* in Benguet requires community involvement through cultural events, food processing training, cultural advocacy, and sustainable practices. These efforts aim to strengthen local identity and ensure that *kiniing* remains a valued cultural food for both present and future generations.

Based on the data, six (6) out of seven (7) respondents, shared that they actively promote or sell *kiniing* during local festivals and events like the Adivay Festival, Strawberry Festival, Bendian Festival, and KADIWA Events. These events serve as important venues not only for selling traditional food but also for introducing *kiniing* to both locals and tourists. All of the respondents stated, “*ishowcase mi ti kiniing mi ti Adivay Festival tapno maipromote, maka attract ti tourist santu ag create market opportunities,*” the respondents showcase their *kiniing* at the Adivay Festival to promote it, attract tourists, and create market opportunities. This aligns with the purpose of cultural festivals, which is to promote indigenous products through community gatherings and celebration. Respondent seven (7) recalled, “*adda 40 turista nga inmay idi Strawberry Festival, nacurious da, ket pinadas da nangan. Idi napadasan da ti kiniing, ket nagsubli da met nga naggatang.*” Recalled, there were 40 tourists who came during the Strawberry Festival. They got curious and tried eating it. After tasting the *kiniing*, they came back and bought more. This shows how tourists, once exposed to *kiniing*, tend to spread interest to others, helping boost awareness and market reach. This finding is strongly supported by Castillo et al. (2024), who emphasized that the Adivay

Festival plays a vital role in promoting indigenous identity and values, by providing a platform to share local food, dances, and culture with a wider audience. Likewise, Secret Philippines (2023) explained that festivals like Adivay are effective tools for cultural preservation because they provide a public stage for traditions to remain visible and appreciated. Thus, the data shows that these events do not just serve as markets but also as opportunities to celebrate heritage.

In addition to local festivals, respondents also mentioned the importance of participating in KADIWA Events. Respondent one (1) shared that they joined both the Adivay Festival and the KADIWA Program, “*ipropromote mi met ken ilaklako mi jay product mi directly ti buyers,*” the respondent also promote and sell their product directly to buyers. KADIWA, short for *Katuwang sa Diwa at Gawa para sa Masaganang Ani at Mataas na Kita*, is a national program by the Department of Agriculture that helps local farmers and producers sell their goods directly to consumers. This reduces prices for buyers and increases income for producers. As described by the respondents, this kind of direct-selling platform helps promote traditional foods like *kiniing* by providing access to a broader consumer base without relying on middlemen. This is supported by Bombio (2023), who found that the KADIWA program strengthens local food systems by linking producers directly with consumers, boosting incomes while promoting traditional goods. Similarly, DA Press Office (2020) highlighted that more than 12,000 farmers and buyers benefited from KADIWA, making it a successful model for food affordability and cultural promotion. The findings clearly show that respondents benefit from participating in this program not just through sales, but by strengthening community ties and pride in traditional products.

Moreover, respondents expressed that joining cultural festivals encourages younger generations to appreciate and learn how to prepare traditional food. Respondent one (1) stated, “*ag ilaklako kami during festivals ta ag encourages ti youth, ta adalenda ti tradition ti panagaramid ti kiniing. Tapnu haan nga malipatan daytoy,*” the respondent sell during festivals because it encourages the youth to learn the tradition of making kiniing, so that it will not be forgotten. Respondent seven (7) shared that “*uray no saan ammo dagiti turista ti kiniing idi umuna, nu macurious da ket gumatang da met,*” the respondent said that even if tourists don’t know about kiniing at first, once they get curious, they end up buying it too. This suggests that participating in public events opens doors for cultural education and memory, especially among the youth who are often influenced by modern technologies and may forget traditional practices. This idea is supported by Lamsis (2024), who pointed out that traditional food like *kiniing* holds not only economic value but also strong cultural meaning. He emphasized that public promotion of traditional food encourages pride, especially in younger people, and strengthens the continuity of food heritage. The role of festivals in teaching and transmitting cultural knowledge is also affirmed by Ellis (2020), who noted that community food programs help bridge generational gaps through food storytelling, preparation, and sharing.

On the other hand, only one (1) out of seven (7) respondents, respondent three (3) stated that they did not participate in cultural events, citing limited resources, “*gaputa bassit laeng ti karnean mi ken awan ti dakkel nga kapital nga mausar tapno makiparticipate ti dakkel nga festival or event,*” the respondent said that because they only have a small meat shop and no large capital to use, they cannot participate in big festivals or events. However, this respondent still believed

in the value of these festivals. The respondent mentioned that when others join, “*makaencourage met ketdi dagitoy festival ti dadduma nga tao tapnu tuloy-tuloyen da dagiti ug-ugali wenno tradisyon ken makatulong kadagiti ubbing tapno ammu da,*” the respondent stated that these festivals also encourage other people to continue their customs and traditions, and help the youth to know and understand them. Despite not being directly involved, this view acknowledges the impact that cultural events have on the preservation of heritage and identity. This perspective echoes what was reported by the Philippine Information Agency (2023), which stated that government events like KADIWA empower farmers and strengthen traditional practices, even among those who cannot always join due to capacity issues. Therefore, even the respondent who did not participate recognizes the larger benefit these cultural engagements bring to the community.

The findings strongly support the Cultural Sustainability Theory, which states that culture can only survive if it is continuously practiced and passed down across generations. Festivals like Adivay and Strawberry Festival serve as interactive spaces where culture is not only performed but also experienced and remembered. The participation of *kiniing* makers in such events confirms the role of community engagement, a key component of the theory, in preserving local identity and foodways.

Additionally, the results support the Heritage Food Systems Theory which views traditional food as a cultural asset with both economic and symbolic value. The respondents’ participation in festivals and KADIWA programs demonstrate how traditional food is not only a product but also a symbol of identity, resilience, and history. These platforms allow producers to maintain tradition while adapting to modern market needs.

Based on the data, four (4) out of seven (7) respondents, confirmed that they had attended food processing training programs related to sanitation, food safety, and proper packaging of *kiniing*. Respondent one (1) shared that they joined a training focused on Meat Processing with GMP Good Manufacturing Practices, which included proper meat handling, sanitation, disease control, and ensuring the cleanliness of the working environment. This respondent explained that, *“makatulong dagiti kastuy nga training tapno maimprove jay kalidad ken safety ti kiniing, ken to gain the trust ti customers,”* trainings like this help improve the quality and safety of their *kiniing*, and also help gain the trust of customers. This finding is supported by Aly (2023), who explained that GMP training improves hygiene, ensures product quality, and boosts customer confidence in traditional smoked food products like fish and meat. The data is also backed by the Department of Agriculture, which emphasized that GMP helps local producers meet food safety standards and improve their production process (Know GMPs, 2024). Thus, the result shows that GMP training not only supports better food safety but also helps preserve traditional food preparation in a safer way. Respondent four (4) shared that they attended two separate trainings provided by the Tawangan Agrarian Reform Community Multi-Purpose Cooperative (TARC MPC). These included one (1) for meat processing and one (1) for packaging and labeling. The training helped them handle meat properly and present the product better. The respondent stated, *“haya da daka pan itudo man ka untulong matlang ni un pahad i kalidad tan ang ang ni produkto uno lako, hay maidawtan pay ni interes hutada kustumers,”* the respondent indicated that what they teach has helped improve the quality and appearance of the product, and it also increased buyer interest even more. This means that the knowledge gained helped improve the quality and appearance of

their *kiniing* and increased customer interest. This is supported by the FDA Academy (2024), which emphasized that proper labeling and packaging not only meet food laws but also make traditional products more marketable and appealing. According to the Hygiene & Packaging Guide (2019), food safety and visual presentation are key to attracting more customers, especially in small businesses selling native food products. Respondent five (5) mentioned that they joined a training by the Igorota Association, which focused on sanitation, food safety, packaging, and labeling, while keeping the traditional methods of preparing *kiniing*. The training helped ensure that their product was clean, safe, and well-presented. This approach is supported by Tan (2024), who emphasized that combining indigenous food preparation with modern safety standards helps balance tradition and consumer protection. The data supports that training like these help producers follow industry practices while still preserving cultural identity. Respondent seven (7) joined a Food Handling Seminar that taught cleanliness and hygiene during food preparation. The respondent explained that workers were guided before starting work and that they even hired part-time students to handle dishwashing to maintain cleanliness. This shows the practical use of the training in daily operations. This is supported by the Philippine FDA's Administrative Order No. 2014-0030, which outlines proper handling, sanitation, and cleanliness standards for food businesses (PNTR, 2014). This shows that when producers apply this food safety practices, the result is cleaner and safer traditional food that meets public health requirements

While four (4) respondents had attended formal training, three (3) respondents shared that they had not attended any official training sessions. However, all three (3) still agreed that food processing training would help improve

kiniing production. Their openness to training suggests a proactive attitude toward learning, despite relying on informal, experience-based knowledge. Respondent two (2) said *nasuroak ag aramid kiniing keni kasinsin ko nga nangrugi ti negosyo.*” Respondent said they learned how to make *kiniing* by observing a cousin who started the business. This method of learning by imitation and hands-on experience reflects how traditional skills are often passed down within families. Respondent three (3) learned from parents, showing a continuation of indigenous knowledge through oral and experiential transmission. Meanwhile, respondent six (6), who was formerly a nurse, explained that he uses personal judgment to ensure that the meat is clean and safe, relying on her background in health. This demonstrates that, while they do not have formal culinary training, they apply relevant knowledge to maintain quality. Despite not being formally trained, these respondents strongly believed that structured learning on sanitation, safety, proper packaging, labeling, pricing, and marketing, while still honoring traditional methods could help them improve their practices. Their willingness to blend traditional practices with modern knowledge reflects a balanced approach that respects cultural roots while embracing food safety and economic sustainability. Respondent two (2) expressed this by saying, *“awan ti pormal nga training mi, ngem mayat met ketdi nu agtraining met jay dadduma about cleanliness, packaging and labeling, ta epreserve ti tradition through modern tools,”* meaning they don’t have formal training, but it would be good if others could also be trained about cleanliness, packaging, and labeling, so that the tradition can be preserved through modern tools. This statement emphasizes that training does not erase tradition but can help strengthen and protect it using updated techniques and safer methods. This view is supported by Ocampo and Salvo (2023), who explained that food training for small producers increases both

the safety and cultural value of local foods by equipping them with the tools and knowledge needed to adapt to modern standards. Also, Molina and Brandiz (2023) stressed that sanitation and hygiene in traditional food systems are key to improving quality and safety without compromising cultural integrity. These sources prove that even without formal training, the producers' belief that education and modern practices can help sustain tradition is valid and research-backed. Their mindset aligns with current recommendations for sustainable development in heritage foods.

The result shows that most of the respondents recognize the importance of food safety training and how it can help them improve the safety, appearance, and marketability of *kiniing*. This supports the Cultural Sustainability Theory, which explains that traditional practices can survive when they are shared and improved through modern systems. The respondents who attended training are proof that traditional food producers can adapt without forgetting their heritage. Training gives them the tools to make *kiniing* safer, more appealing, and easier to sell while still honoring traditional techniques. It also helps small producers connect with more customers, boost income, and pass their knowledge to the next generation. This confirms that when tradition is supported by education and modern tools, it becomes stronger and more sustainable.

Based on the data, all seven (7) respondents promote the culture of Benguet through *kiniing*, utilizing a wide mix of strategies such as posting on social media, participating in local events and contests, involving family members in the preparation process, joining cooperatives, managing restaurants, and creating feedback platforms. These methods serve not just to sell the product, but to preserve, teach, and spread cultural identity through food.

All seven (7) respondents actively utilize Facebook and other digital platforms to promote *kiniing*, not just as a food item, but as a cultural symbol of Benguet. They upload photos of the product, document the smoking process, and engage with potential buyers. Respondent two (2), for instance, shared that “*adda tao from Canada nga nakakita iti post ko ket nu agawid da ket gumatang da iti kiniing.*” The respondent conveyed that someone from Canada saw her post and said that they will buy *kiniing* when they come home. This proves that social media acts as a powerful tool for cultural reach, extending beyond local communities and allowing even overseas Filipinos and foreign audiences to discover and appreciate traditional food. These digital efforts don’t only lead to sales, they introduce cultural practices to global spaces, building cross-border cultural appreciation. According to Biswal and Nickpour (2025), such digital engagements safeguard intangible cultural heritage by creating awareness and cultural continuity in online spaces, especially among younger generations. For *kiniing* makers, social media becomes a virtual storefront and a cultural classroom, where tradition is showcased, preserved, and shared.

Five (5) respondents actively join local food fairs, barangay markets, or festivals to sell *kiniing*, such as during holidays or community gatherings. These are opportunities not just to earn but also to interact directly with the public, explain the preparation process, and demonstrate its traditional value. Respondent seven (7) shared that “*no adda tourist nga mangan ti restoran mi, damagenda no kasano ti panagaramid ti kiniing ket e-explain mi met,*” the respondent explained that when tourists eat at our restaurant, they ask how we make *kiniing*, and we explain it. These face-to-face interactions allow for deeper cultural storytelling. Consumers

are not just buying food, they are learning its backstory, cultural significance, and preparation method. According to Guerrero, Jun, and Jeong (2010), when people hear the origin stories and preparation methods of traditional foods, their emotional attachment increases. It becomes more than just a product, it becomes a cultural experience, enriching the buyer's appreciation and fostering community pride.

Four (4) respondents, emphasized that teaching their children and younger relatives how to prepare *kiniing* is a major way they preserve and promote the tradition. Respondent three (3) stated, “*isuro mi kadagiti ubing wenno aanak tapno saan nga malipatan ti tradision,*” the respondent shared that they teach their children so that the tradition will not be forgotten. This shows that *kiniing-making* is not only a livelihood but also a family tradition passed down through generations. It sustains cultural identity within the household and ensures the practice continues in the future. According to Biswal et al. (2024), the intergenerational transmission of traditional food knowledge is a cornerstone of cultural preservation. When families make a conscious effort to teach the next generation, the tradition becomes rooted in both memory and skill, even as the outside world modernizes.

Three (3) respondents, promote *kiniing* by incorporating it into organized business efforts, such as restaurants and cooperatives. Respondent four (4) is part of the *Tawangan Agrarian Reform Community Multi-Purpose Cooperative (TARCMPC)*, which sells *kiniing* during public events like the Bendian Festival. Respondent six (6) mentioned that “*iwarwaras da ti kiniing kadagiti aggang ita entero a pagilian, a pakinabangan da ti ad-adu a panagsuplay,*” the respondent indicated they distribute *kiniing* to buyers nationwide, taking advantage of broader supply networks. These organized systems help strengthen economic resilience while keeping the product culturally rooted. The cooperative, for instance, is not

just a business, it is a community support system that gives small producers a platform to share and market their traditional products. As supported by Clemson University Cooperative Extension (2023), such models empower local producers, enhance visibility for traditional goods, and retain cultural value while responding to market demands.

Respondents six (6) and seven (7) go even further by participating in cultural seminars, food contests, and digital storytelling through Facebook pages like *Kinudayan* restaurant, respondent seven (7). Respondent six (6), who is also a social media influencer, stated that “*ibingay da ti pammadayaw da iti panag aramid ti kiniing kadagiti kompetision ken community talks tapno makatulong da iti panangisuro kadagiti dadduma ken tapno mai keep ti kultura,*” they share their *kiniing* experience in contests and community talks to help educate others and keep the culture alive. Respondent seven (7) uses the *Kinudayan* facebook page to post photos, customer feedback, and stories, even reposting comments from customers to show pride and build engagement. These interactive methods are examples of modern participatory heritage preservation. When customers post their own photos or share their experiences with *kiniing*, it becomes a community-wide celebration of culture, not just a one-way promotion. According to ScienceDirect (2024), user-generated content increases emotional connection to traditional foods, especially when stories, comments, and experiences are shared publicly. This builds collective memory, cultural pride, and motivates more people especially youth to take interest in preserving traditional practices.

All seven (7) respondents engage in promoting *kiniing* through social media, public events, teaching between older and younger generations, working together through groups like cooperatives, and sharing stories that show how culture is part

of daily life. These findings support the Cultural Sustainability Theory, which states that traditions must be actively shared, adapted, and taught to remain alive. The mix of digital outreach, in-person education, and community-driven sales reflects a dynamic cultural practice.

Moreover, these strategies align with the Heritage Food Systems sub-theory, suggesting that for cultural foods to stay relevant, they must be visible, shared, and meaningfully practiced. The respondents' integrated approach ensures *kiniing* remains a living symbol of Benguet identity, accessible, recognized, and preserved across generations and geographies.

Based on the data, all seven (7) respondents use different strategies to raise awareness about the benefits of *kiniing* for both locals and tourists, focusing mainly on its cultural value, livelihood contribution, and traditional origins. All seven (7) respondents emphasized the role of social media campaigns and restaurant menu placements as key promotional strategies. Respondent one(1) explained, “*tapnu maipakaammo jay kiniing inaynayun mi jay kiniing ti menu ti lokal a restoran ken kapehan*”, which means to raise awareness about *kiniing*, the respondent include it in the menus of local restaurants and cafés. This supports the idea that food visibility in everyday establishments helps reach more customers. Meanwhile, Respondent six (6) emphasized the traditional purpose of *kiniing* by stating, “*originally naaramid ti kiniing to preserve meat ta awan refrigerator idi*,” meaning *kiniing* was originally made to preserve meat when there were no refrigerators. This educational effort helps customers understand that *kiniing* is not only tasty but also historically significant, allowing it to serve as a cultural bridge between past and present. These strategies reflect findings by Biswal and Nickpour (2025), who observed that digital storytelling combined with culinary tourism significantly

increases public appreciation for heritage foods. Likewise, the Philippine Department of Tourism (2023) explains that listing indigenous dishes on restaurant menus and featuring them in digital and physical platforms significantly boosts awareness and supports local producers, aligning perfectly with your statement.

In addition to these strategies, five (5) respondents, suggested integrating *kiniing* into school activities and tourism brochures as a way to reach younger generations and travelers. Respondent three (3) shared, “*inayun da jay kiniing nu ada school programs, ta maapreciate da ti culture tayo,*” the respondent conveyed that *kiniing* can be include in school programs so they will appreciate our culture. Similarly, respondent four (4) said, “*ifeature kuma matlang i kiniing di brochure para dan ta turismo, hayadan strategy man ka untulong ni maipa amtai kiniing di lokal tan hutada turista,*” featuring *kiniing* in tourism brochures helps inform both locals and tourists. These statements indicate that education and tourism outreach can play a powerful role in promoting food heritage, especially when young people and visitors are the targets. This approach is in line with UNESCO’s (2011) emphasis on embedding intangible cultural heritage in both educational curriculum and tourism materials to safeguard traditions. Promoting *kiniing* this way not only strengthens cultural pride and community identity but also ensures that the practice is passed on and understood by a broader audience, both local and international. Through these efforts, the producers not only preserve the product itself but also deepen public understanding of its significance to Benguet’s identity and livelihood.

The data clearly shows that respondents intentionally use social media, educational outreach, tourism materials, and restaurant inclusion to spread awareness about *kiniing*, combining digital platforms and real-world experiences.

These strategies support the Cultural Sustainability Theory, which emphasizes that cultural elements remain alive when embedded in everyday practices and shared across generations. By promoting *kiniing* in menus, classrooms, and online, producers reinforce its presence in both local culture and tourism sectors.

The use of multi-layered awareness efforts aligns with the Heritage Food Systems sub-theory, which asserts that heritage foods must be produced, shared, taught, and showcased in public settings to maintain relevance. Through their combined efforts, the respondents ensure that *kiniing* remains visible, appreciated, and economically supported, preserving Benguet's cultural identity while adapting to modern market environments.

Based on the data, in terms of preserving the tradition and ensuring long-term production, all seven (7) respondents consistently emphasized that training the youth is the most vital strategy for sustaining *kiniing* in their communities. As respondent one (1) stated, “*tapno saan a maawanan ti kina-kultura mi, masapul nga maipasa kadagiti ubbing dagiti ammo nga panagaramid ti kiniing,*” meaning so that they don't lose their cultural identity, it is important to pass down the skills to the youth to know how to make *kiniing*. This highlights that cultural foods like *kiniing* are not just recipes, they represent identity, history, and lived experience. When elders pass down skills to the younger generation, they are also transferring values, stories, and community pride. If youth are not engaged, the practice risks fading with the older generation. Teaching the next generation helps ensure the process, flavor, and meaning behind *kiniing* remains intact, even as times change. This insight clearly reflects the strong belief that knowledge transfer between generations is key to cultural preservation. This view aligns with UNESCO (2011), which emphasized that intergenerational transmission of knowledge is vital to

safeguarding intangible cultural heritage (p. 12). Thus, by mentoring the youth, the respondents ensure that *kiniing* continues to exist not just as a product, but as a lived cultural tradition embedded in local identity and family practice.

In addition, six (6) out of seven (7) respondents, stressed the importance of government support, including financial assistance, training, and marketing. Respondent seven (7) mentioned, “*kailangan metlang ti tulong ti gobyerno, ta adu ti gastos iti baboy ken panagproseso.*” The respondent pointed out that they need the help of the government because the cost of pigs and processing is high. The rising cost of inputs threatens sustainability, and government intervention is seen as a lifeline. This also emphasizes that even with strong cultural commitment from producers, external support is necessary to protect traditional livelihoods. Rising costs of livestock, feed, and fuel for smoking jeopardize the ability of small-scale producers to continue their craft. Without subsidies or programs that support heritage food producers, economic challenges can overpower cultural intentions. Government aid in the form of training, marketing platforms, or access is essential to balance the cultural and business sides of *kiniing* production. According to the National Commission for Culture and the Arts (2020), community-based workshops and support mechanisms contribute to the transmission of traditional knowledge. This suggests that government assistance not only addresses financial burdens but also reinforces the continuation of traditional food practices by making them viable under modern economic conditions.

Moreover, five (5) respondents recommended forming partnerships with tourism offices and local businesses to increase visibility and consumer reach. Respondent two (2) explained, “*nu inaynayon ti restaurant iti kiniing, ket makatulong tapnu maipaka ammu iti market,*” the respondent recounted that if

restaurants include *kiniing*, it helps in spreading awareness in the market. These partnerships help link culture with economic growth. This shows that tourism and business collaboration can act as bridges to introduce traditional food to wider and more diverse audiences. When *kiniing* is made available in cafés, restaurants, or food exhibits, especially in tourist-heavy areas, its visibility increases and it becomes more familiar to outsiders. These platforms also create income for producers while educating the public about the cultural value of the product. Through strategic partnerships, *kiniing* shifts from being just a home-prepared food to a recognized symbol of local identity. The Philippine Department of Tourism (2023) states that culinary heritage is a strong tourism draw, indicating that heritage foods like *kiniing* can become sustainable when embedded in tourism systems, further supporting livelihoods while preserving tradition.

Three (3) respondents shared ideas related to product innovation that still respect tradition, such as marinating *kiniing* in adobo seasoning or freezing marinated meat for longer shelf life. Respondent one (1) explained, “*ti adobo nga adda flavoring na ket makatulong iti raman, ken ti freezing ket makatulong iti storage,*” the respondent explained that the adobo flavoring helps improve taste, and freezing helps with storage. These small innovations do not alter the traditional identity of *kiniing* but improve its accessibility and marketability. This also highlights that tradition and innovation are not opposites. Small modifications such as using local seasonings or improving preservation techniques can help *kiniing* meet modern market standards like food safety, shelf stability, and flavor diversity. These changes make it easier to sell *kiniing* in stores or ship it to new locations without sacrificing its cultural essence. Innovations tailored for quality, not convenience, can draw new consumers while still honoring tradition. This approach

reflects Slow Food International (2021), which notes that the evolution of a food product can help revive traditional recipes. Respectful innovation enhances both taste and practicality, making *kiniing* more competitive in modern markets while safeguarding cultural roots.

Furthermore, two (2) respondents recognized the power of digital media and content creation in expanding the reach of *kiniing*. Respondent six (6) shared that, “*dagiti tao iti abroad nga makakita ti kiniing iti online ket agbuybuya da ken agorder da met,*” as stated by the respondent people abroad who see *kiniing* online watch and also place orders. Social media and vlogging help transform *kiniing* into a recognizable product beyond Benguet. This emphasizes that digital platforms offer powerful tools for cultural preservation. When producers use Facebook, YouTube, or TikTok to share stories, preparation steps, or customer reactions, they’re not just marketing, they are educating a global audience. The reach of online platforms allows *kiniing* to be known by Filipinos abroad or curious tourists. This visibility increases appreciation, customer base, and recognition, showing how technology, when used thoughtfully, can amplify indigenous food traditions. According to the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO, 2021), digital media and storytelling are essential in preserving indigenous food knowledge and spreading awareness globally. Through digital channels, *kiniing* can transcend local boundaries and become part of a global conversation about heritage food. Lastly, Respondent seven (7) brought attention to the need to lower the cost of pigs and feed, improve storage techniques, and expand physical outlets. They said, “*ti gastos ti baboy ken feeds ket ngumina ti presyo isunga pati kiniing ngumina, isunga kayat mi ti tulong ti gobyerno,*” the respondent indicated that since the cost of pigs and feed is rising, *kiniing* prices also go up, that’s why we need government help. This

highlights the economic challenge of maintaining artisanal food products in a competitive market. This response reveals the difficult reality that traditional food production cannot be separated from economics. While cultural passion drives producers, sustainability depends on resources and infrastructure. If pig prices are high, producers may reduce output, or raise prices making *kiniing* less accessible to everyday buyers and tourists. Expanding distribution points and improving storage allows *kiniing* to reach more markets and stay fresh longer. It also reinforces the need for policy-level solutions without affordable inputs and logistical support, even culturally rich products like *kiniing* risk becoming unsustainable. The FAO (2021) confirms that small-scale food producers must balance economic survival with maintaining artisanal quality. Improving infrastructure, affordability, and market presence allows *kiniing* to be more accessible to both locals and tourists while remaining true to its cultural essence.

The data strongly supports the Cultural Sustainability Theory, which emphasizes the importance of passing down traditions and protecting them within community, education, and economic frameworks. The respondents' focus on training the youth, seeking government help, and using new platforms like tourism and social media supports this theory by showing how culture can survive when actively supported and practiced across generations.

It also aligns with the Heritage Food Systems sub-theory, which highlights that traditional foods are sustained through a balance of innovation, education, institutional support, and economic viability. The strategies shared such as innovation through adobo flavors and freezing, using online platforms, and creating business partnerships clearly reflect how cultural foods like *kiniing* can evolve without losing authenticity.

CHAPTER IV

CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

This chapter presents the conclusions drawn from the findings and the recommendations. Based on the results, the following conclusions and recommendations were formulated.

Conclusions

1. *Kiniing* producers in Benguet use both traditional and modern methods.

Traditionally, they apply only salt and smoke the meat using open-fire setups like the *pugon*. Modernized practices involve marinating the meat and using enclosed metal drums for safer, more consistent smoking. Interviews reveal that most producers combine both methods, depending on safety, resources, and market demand. This shows that while they adapt for practicality and hygiene, they still preserve essential cultural practices.

2. *Kiniing* producers face many challenges in keeping *kiniing* as a traditional food while meeting what customers expect today. The researchers found that problems include the rising cost and limited supply of smoking woods like alnus and guava, not having enough tools for proper packaging, small or crowded workspaces, and high costs because pig prices are going up. Also, fewer young people are interested in learning how to make *kiniing*. Some producers face strong competition from cheaper, imported smoked meats that are easier to find in stores. They also struggle to follow modern food safety and packaging standards while trying to keep their traditional way of making *kiniing*.

3. There are strategies that need to be implemented to sustain the preservation

of *kiniing* in Benguet. Based on the results, the researchers concluded that the sustainability of *kiniing* production depends on strong community-based strategies. These include the formation of cooperatives, participation in cultural festivals, and use of social media for promotion, and training in food safety and processing. The active involvement of local government units (LGUs), schools, and cultural institutions is necessary to promote awareness, protect the product as cultural heritage, and encourage youth participation. Most respondents believe that additional support through formal recognition, access to resources, and community events can help preserve the tradition while adapting to modern demands.

Recommendations

1. Researchers encourage the producers to prioritize traditional *kiniing* methods while limiting modernization to protect its cultural value. These practices should be passed on to the youth with support from agencies like NCIP National Commission on Indigenous Peoples and IPMR Indigenous Peoples Mandatory Representative.
2. To address production challenges, producers should use sustainable wood, undergo food safety training, and improve processing methods to meet consumer expectations.
3. For long-term sustainability, producers are encouraged to form cooperatives, register with FDA Food and Drug Administration and DTI Department of Trade and Industry, seek heritage recognition, collaborate with tourism offices, promote *kiniing* through festivals, and gain government support to expand markets and protect cultural identity.

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APPENDICES

Letters

	King's College of the Philippines Research Ethics Committee
	Approval Letter (Amendment)

Date: 15 April 2025

KCP-REC Application Serial Number: **024s2025**

Name of the Principal Researcher: **Canute, Cristine**

Address of the Principal Research: **Puguis, La Trinidad, Benguet**

Title of the Proposal: **"KINIING: Preserving the Cultural Food of Benguet in the Food Industry"**

Researchers: Amando, Tina Flor
Baskial, Jexcel
Cagas, Mckenly Raj
Canute, Cristine
Galao-ey, Justine Cyrille
Montano, Kelburn

Dear Mr./Ms. Canute, Cristine

Re: Request for amendment

The following documents were duly received by this office from you on the said dates:

Document	Version No	Submission Date
1 st Proposal	1	27 February 2025
2 nd Proposal	1	14 April 2025
3 rd Proposal	1	15 April 2025

Thank you for informing the committee about the changes to your current and approved research proposal. We hereby approve your request for amendment as follows:

Research Title:

From: KINIING: Reliving Food Culture in the Modern Food Industry in Benguet

To: KINIING: Preserving Benguet Food Culture in the Food Industry

Problem

Statements: From:

1. What are the traditional Kining production methods of the 13 municipalities in the province of Benguet?
2. What are the ways the people are preserving these methods and revitalizing them in the context of the modern food industry? **To:**
 1. What are the traditional Kining production methods in the 10 barangays of the municipality of La Trinidad, Benguet?
 2. How do the people of La Trinidad preserve the traditional identity of Kining while adapting to food industry standards and trends?

This document serves as confirmation of your eligibility to proceed to the next stage of your research.

We wish you success in your research work and look forward to supporting you in future stages of the research process.

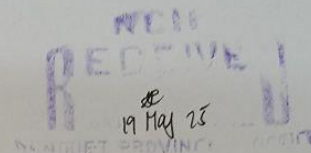
More grace,

Zaldivar E. Acodesin
Chairperson



MAY 19, 2025

ENGR. ALLAN W. ALLATIS
Provincial Officer
NCIP Benguet Provincial Office



Sir/Ma'am,

Greetings of peace and good health!

We, the Bachelor of Science in Hospitality Management students of King's College of the Philippines, are currently conducting a research study titled: **"KINIING: Preserving the Cultural Food of Benguet in the Food Industry."**

This study aims to:

- Document the traditional production methods of Kiniing in selected municipalities of Benguet;
- Identify the challenges faced by Kiniing makers in preserving this traditional food while meeting consumer expectations; and
- Propose a strategic plan to help sustain and preserve Kiniing in the food industry.

To conduct this study, qualitative research method with a Grounded Theory approach is used to guide the research process in exploring and understanding the traditional practices, challenges, and implementation to sustain the preservation of Kiniing in Benguet.

This study is only possible with the help and support of your good office. Rest assured that all information gathered shall be for academic purpose only and shall be treated with outmost confidentiality. And also, all information will be kept confidential under the Republic Act No. 10173, otherwise known as the Data Privacy Act.

Your favorable response to this matter will be very much appreciated. God bless and more power!

Respectfully Yours,

Amando, Tina Flor

Baskial, Jexcel

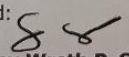
Cagas, Mckenly Raj

Canute, Cristine

Galao-ey, Justine Cyrille

Montano, Kelburn

Noted:


Dolsey Wreth P. Sapi
Instructor

Sample Letter Per Municipality



Republic of the Philippines
 Cordillera Administrative Region
 Province of Benguet
MUNICIPALITY OF BUGUIAS
OFFICE OF THE MAYOR



May 19, 2025

MISS TINA FLOR AMANDO, et.al
 King's College of the Philippines
 Pico, La Trinidad, Benguet

RECEIVED COPY

Received by: KIER M. BICO

Date: May 20, 2025 5:00 P.M.

Madame/Sir:

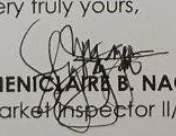
Warm greetings!

In response to your letter dated May 14, 2025, the following is a list of business owners who are engaged in the selling and processing meat, locally known as "kiniing". This information underscores the key players in our community's meat industry.

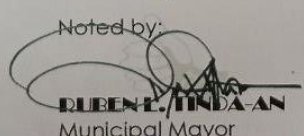
No.	Name of Owner	Business Name	Business Address
1	Allan Asingco Bentadan	Trackson Smoked Meat Production	Abatan, Buguias, Benguet
2	Paul Francis Malinga	Paul's Meat Booth	Bot-oan, Catlubong, Buguias, Benguet
3	Eduardo Sonny Tamoy Toda	Little Expressway	Seb-itan, Sebang, Buguias, Benguet
4	Aileen Depawa Magayam	Mikee and Nicoles Sari-sari Store	Bad-ayan, Baculongan Sur, Buguias, Benguet
5	Reabel Luis Pasngadan	Ron Dwyn Store	Man-atong, Baculongan Norte, Buguias, Benguet

Thank you very much.

Very truly yours,


PHENICLAIRE B. NAGAYOS
 Market Inspector II/ BPLO Designate

Noted by:


RUBEN L. TINDA-AN
 Municipal Mayor



+63 945 375 8135
 Lgu Buguias
 mayors8588@yahoo.com
 mayors8588@gmail.com
 2F Municipal Hall, Abatan, Buguias, Benguet



Republic of the Philippines
Province of Benguet

MUNICIPALITY OF LA TRINIDAD
OFFICE OF THE MUNICIPAL MAYOR

La Trinidad Municipal Hall, Km. 5, La Trinidad, Benguet 2601
Tel. No.: (074) 422-2601 / 422-5618 | Fax No.: (074) 422-5621
Official Website: www.la Trinidad.gov.ph | Email Address: mayorslt@yahoo.com

PERMIT

NO. 0170-2025

(CONDUCT STUDY/SURVEY)

PERMIT IS HEREBY GRANTED to the following **3RD YEAR BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN HOSPITALITY MANAGEMENT** students at King's College of the Philippine, Inc. to conduct data gathering activities in connection with their study entitled "Kiniing: Preserving the Cultural Food of Benguet in the Food Industry," in partial fulfillment of the requirements of their subject Research in Hospitality Management:

- a. AMANDO, TINA FLOR
- b. CANUTE, CRISTINE
- c. BASKIAL, JEXCEL
- d. GALAO-EY, JUSTINE CYRILLE
- e. CAGAS, MCKENLY RAJ
- f. MONTANO, KELBURN

They may distribute questionnaires, conduct interviews, and gather data from individuals, barangays, establishments and offices in La Trinidad, Benguet provided these shall be used for the above stated purpose only. Information gathered shall be considered confidential. A copy of the study/research shall be provided by the municipality through the Office of the Municipal Mayor.

Issued this 16th day of May, 2025 at La Trinidad, Benguet Province.

FOR : **ROMEO K. SALDA**
Municipal Mayor

BY : 
MYANNE B. SALDA
Municipal Administrator

NOT VALID WITHOUT OFFICIAL SEAL

O.R # : 4044348
Paid on : May 16, 2025
Paid at : La Trinidad, Benguet
Amount Paid : Php50.00

Interview Questionnaires

Title:

“*Kiniing*: Preserving the Cultural Food of Benguet in the Food Industry”

Instruction:

Please answer the questions based on your experience with *kiniing*. Your honest responses will help in understanding and preserving *kiniing* in Benguet. All answers will be kept confidential and be used for educational purposes. Thank you!

SECTION 1: What are the traditional *kiniing* production methods of the selected municipalities of Benguet?

1. Street, Barangay, Municipality:
2. For how many years have you been preparing *kiniing*? What is your reason for producing *kiniing*?
3. What are the methods you use in processing *kiniing*?
4. Where do you usually source the pig meat you are using for production of *kiniing*? Can you describe why you choose that source?
5. What type of wood do you prefer for smoking *kiniing*? Why?
6. How long does the smoking process usually take? Can you explain why that time frame is followed?
7. What smoking process do you use in producing *kiniing*? Please describe.

SECTION 2: What are the challenges encountered by the producers in preserving *kiniing* as a traditional food while meeting consumer expectations?

1. What challenges do you experience in the increasing market price of pigs use for *kiniing* production?
2. What difficulties do you encounter regarding the availability of materials use for *kiniing*?
3. What challenges do you experience in your *kiniing* marketability in today's generation of consumers?
4. Can you describe the type of competition you are experiencing in selling *kiniing*, and how it affects your production and pricing?

SECTION 3: What needs to be implemented to sustain the preservation of *kiniing* in Benguet?

1. Community Engagement
 - a) Are you currently promoting or selling *kiniing* during cultural events like the Strawberry Festival or Adivay Festival? If yes, what is this and how do you think this cultural events can help in promoting *kiniing*? If not, why?
2. Food Processing Training
 - a) Have you attended or are you currently doing any food processing training to help improve your *kiniing* production to meet food industry standards while still preserving its traditional preparation methods? If yes, what kind of training was it, and how has it helped you?
3. Advocacy and Awareness
 - a) In what ways do you promote the culture of Benguet through *kiniing*? Why?
 - b) How can you raise awareness on the benefits of *kiniing* for local and tourist serving as consumers? Why?
4. Sustainability
 - a) Do you have more suggestions that you think that can ensure the sustainability of *kiniing* production in your community? Why?

Documentations

Interview at Caliking, Atok, Benguet



Interview at Man-Atong, Baculongan Norte, Bugias, Benguet



Interview at Seb-itan, Sebang, Bugias, Benguet



Interview of a kining producer, resident from Kabayan



Interview of a kining producer, resident from Kibungan



Interview at Beckel, La Trinidad, Benguet



Closed Area – Drum Type Smoker of Etag TV/ Kasakmowl Restaurant



Interview at Puguis, La Trinidad, Benguet



CURICULLUM VITAE

NAME: Amando, Tina Flor L.

Current Address: Upper Bayabas, Pico, La Trinidad, Benguet

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Date of Birth:	OCTOBER 14, 2001
Place of Birth:	BAGUIO CITY
Citizenship:	FILIPINO
Civil Status:	SINGLE
Provincial Address:	TUBLAY, BENGUET

EDUCATION

Tertiary:	KINGS COLLEGE OF THE PHILIPPINES Pico, La Trinidad, Benguet (2022- Present)
Secondary	
Senior High:	TUBLAY SCHOOL OF HOME INDUSTRIES Acop, Tublay, Benguet (2018-2019)
Junior High:	TUBLAY SCHOOL OF HOME INDUSTRIES Acop, Tublay, Benguet (2016-2017)
Elementary:	MAMUYOD ELEMENTARY SCHOOL Mamuyod, Ambassador, Tublay, Benguet (2012-2013)

ACHIEVEMENTS/CERTIFICATIONS:

- Bread and Pastry Production NCII (January, 2023)
- Cookery NCII (July, 2023)
- Seminar and Hotel Familiarization (May, 2023)
- Housekeeping NC II (March, 2023)
- Food Handlers Orientation (October, 2022)
- Basic First Aid Training (October, 2022)

Name: Baskial, Jexcel S.

Current Address: FD272 Pines Park, Balili, La Trinidad, Benguet

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Date of Birth: JUNE 14, 2004
Place of Birth: Kapangan, Benguet
Citizenship: FILIPINO
Civil Status: SINGLE
Provincial Address: KABAYAN, BENGUET

EDUCATION

Tertiary: KINGS COLLEGE OF THE PHILIPPINES
Pico, La Trinidad, Benguet (2022- Present)
Secondary
Senior High: ST. PAULS ACADEMY OF SAYANGAN INC.
Km50, Sayangan, Paoy, Atok, Benguet (2029-2021)
Junior High: ST. PAULS ACADEMY OF SAYANGAN INC.
Km50 Sayangan, Paoy, Atok, Benguet (2015-2019)
Elementary: JAMES CALABIAS ELEMENTARY SCHOOL
Pacso, Kabayan, Benguet (2009-2015)

ACHIEVEMENTS/CERTIFICATIONS:

- Cookery NCII (July, 2023)
- Seminar and Hotel Familiarization (May, 2023)
- Housekeeping II (March, 2023)
- Food Handlers Orientation (October, 2022)
- Basic First Aid Training (October, 2022)

NAME: Cagas, Mckenly Raj B.
Current Address: Balili, La Trinidad, Benguet

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Date of Birth: March 27 2004
Place of Birth: Atok District Hospital
Citizenship: FILIPINO
Civil Status: SINGLE
Provincial Address: Atok, Benguet

EDUCATION

Tertiary: KINGS COLLEGE OF THE PHILIPPINES
Pico, La Trinidad, Benguet (2022- Present)
Secondary
Senior High: TSHI-Sayangan Extension
Paoay, Atok, Benguet (2021-2022)
Junior High: Saints Paul's Academy of Sayangan Inc.
Paoay, Atok, Benguet (2019-2020)
Elementary: Celo Haight Elementary school
Paoay, Atok, Benguet (2014-2015)

ACHIEVEMENTS/CERTIFICATIONS:

- Pasta Making Contest Annual Skills Olympics 1st Place (March 2024)
- Seminar and Hotel Familiarization (May, 2023)
- National Certificate II in cookery (July, 2023)
- Pasta and Sauce Showdown- Hotel and Restaurant Association of Baguio
- Bronze Medal Awardee (September, 2023)
Baguio Country Club - Camp John Hay Baguio City (September 21-23, 2023)
- Food Handlers Orientation (October, 2022)
- Basic First Aid Training (October, 2022)

NAME: Canute, Cristine G.

Current Address: MB389 E-1 Puguis, La Trinidad, Benguet

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Date of Birth: November 21, 2002
Place of Birth: Cordon, Kasibu, Nueva Vizcaya
Citizenship: FILIPINO
Civil Status: SINGLE
Provincial Address: Kasibu, Nueva Vizcaya

EDUCATION

Tertiary: KINGS COLLEGE OF THE PHILIPPINES
Pico, La Trinidad, Benguet (2022- Present)
Secondary
Senior High: KONGKONG VALLEY NATIONAL HIGH SCHOOL
Kongkong, Kasibu, Nueva Vizcaya (2019-2021)
Junior High: KONGKONG VALLEY NATIONAL HIGHS CHOOOL
Kongkong, Kasibu, Nueva Vizcaya (2015-2019)
Elementary: MACALONG ELEMENTARY SCHOOL
Macalong, Kasibu, Nueva Vizcaya (2014-2015)

ACHIEVEMENTS/CERTIFICATIONS:

- Certificate of Training Events Management Services (May 30, 2024)
- Cookery NCII (July 12, 2023)
- Seminar and Hotel Familiarization (May 12-13, 2023)
- Certificate of Training Contact Center Services (March 13, 2024)
- Housekeeping NCII (March 5, 2023)
- Basic First Aid Training (October 07, 2022)
- Food Handlers Orientation (October 06, 2022)

NAME: Galao-ey, Justine Cyrille C.
Current Address: Palmaville, Puguis, La Trinidad, Benguet

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Date of Birth: July 22, 2004
Place of Birth: Baculungan Norte, Buguias, Benguet
Citizenship: FILIPINO
Civil Status: SINGLE
Provincial Address: BUGUIAS, BENGUET

EDUCATION

Tertiary: KINGS COLLEGE OF THE PHILIPPINES
Pico, La Trinidad, Benguet (2022- Present)

Secondary

Senior High: BENGUET NATIONAL HIGH SCHOOL
Wangal, La Trinidad, Benguet (2021-2022)

Junior High: BENGUET NATIONAL HIGH SCHOOL
Wangal, La Trinidad, Benguet (2019-2020)

Elementary: PUGUIS ELEMENTARY SCHOOL
Puguis, La Trinidad, Benguet (2014-2015)

ACHIVEMENTS/CERTIFICATIONS:

- Bread and Pastry Production NCII (January, 2023)
- Cookery NCII (July, 2023)
- Events Management Services NC III (May 30, 2024)
- Seminar and Hotel Familiarization (May, 2023)
- Contact Center Service Certificate (2024)
- Food Handlers Orientation (October, 2022)
- Basic First Aid Training (October, 2023)
- Certificate of Training Housekeeping (March 2023)

NAME: Montano, Kelburn W.

Current Address: Jc 256 Pico, La Trinidad, Benguet

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Date of Birth: June 23 2000
Place of Birth: Pines Doctor's Hospital
Citizenship: FILIPINO
Civil Status: SINGLE
Provincial Address: Baguio City

EDUCATION

Tertiary: KINGS COLLEGE OF THE PHILIPPINES
Pico, La Trinidad, Benguet (2022- Present)
Senior High: KINGS COLLEGE OF THE PHILIPPINES
Pico La Trinidad, Benguet (2019- 2021)
Junior High: STAR COLLEGES
Pico La Trinidad, Benguet (2013-2017)
Elementary: Benguet STATE UNIVERSITY
KM6, La Trinidad, Benguet (2009-2014)

ACHIEVEMENTS/CERTIFICATIONS:

- Food Handlers Orientation (June, 2023)
- Housekeeping II (Jan, 2025)
- CCS II (March, 2024)